

‘Tremble Lasts Forever’

Cultural Tectonics and Seismopolitics

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0.PROOLOGUE

=İlim ilim bilmektir, ilim kendin bilmektir=

<When does a human, especially someone like me, start writing? Or more precisely, when does the lived, the sensed, and the thought reach an intensity that becomes unavoidable to express? I don't know, can one say for oneself that one is in such situation? I don't know. A great pain, perhaps love, or a different tremor suspending an important decision; albeit vaguely, can put oneself in the restlessness of an impending change. It is a fearful anticipation: when one feels this unknown jolt approaching, one does not know what to do for a while. And then with full strength, one embarks on a venture that one has not even dreamed of before - or more precisely, one finds oneself in an action that one had not even dared to think before... (Atay 1998, 17)>

0x0.An Introduction

The present study concerns itself with earthquakes; which, rather than being its objects, become the inspiration for its initiation. It is considered as the factor that makes a beginning in the limit between the no-longer and the not-yet. To be shaken by the seismic waves that tremble the human is to be affected by immanence. This quivering effect resonates in the title, echoing itself in the motion set by those who 'can sense motion in every stillness' and 'can see impermanence in every human achievement' (Seremetakis 2019, 55). The immanence in earthquakes, which makes the beginning, is not to be conflated with a beginning nor an end, which makes it elude thought; those who claimed to have grasped the earthquake, have only grasped the debris with hubris. Such an undertaking is not the concern here, as the clearing of the debris and a pre-emptive defence against hubris are the tasks that seem to arise in conjunction. One can only be grasped by the earthquake, by the shudder of the unsettling tremor coming from no-where. It does not merely shake the foundations of things and concepts we took for certain, grounded in reality; it makes an opening as a fracture in the ground that acts as the foundation, unsettling

‘us’ in uncertainty, entangled with things or concepts. What a ‘mistake’ to have called it ‘fault’, perhaps a trace of its ‘fractality’?

The demonstration of fractal geometry of fault surfaces through a fractal model of topography, has been used to discuss earthquake dynamics elsewhere (Brown and Scholtz 1985; Bhattacharya et al. 2009). The implications of self-similarity or the scale invariance of fractals have also led to the deployment of the concept in the context of Melanesian ethnography, bringing fractals further into the frameworks of social and cultural anthropology. (Damon 1990; Mosko and Damon 2005; Jensen 2006; Strathern 1991; Wagner 1991; 2001). Others have engaged in eschatological discussions of the end of the world as a fractal event (Danowski and Viveros de Castro 2016). This seems to be linked with a broader theme of discussions that has been taking place across human geography and social theory concerning what has been called ‘the politics of scale’, that stress the social construction of scales while problematizing the link between ontology and politics (Smith 1992; Delaney and Leitner 1997; Marston 2000; Swyngedouw and Heynen 2003; Swyngedouw 2004; Blakey 2020). The present study concerning itself with earthquakes, in their relation to fault line fractals and politics of scale, generates the concept of seismopolitics to seize upon the discussions around fractals and scales, delving into the contemporary debates on fractality, the social construction of scales, and their politically contested ‘nature’.

Another concept to think alongside with is cultural tectonics, which necessarily resonates with the theory of plate tectonics, that pertains to the motion of the Earth, describing the inner dynamics and surface movements through various convergences, divergences and transformations. Although the term has been deployed before (Hayward 2000; Hanson 2013), the underlying motive for the deployment of the term has been to describe the impacts of cultural technological processes as analogous to the movement of tectonic plates, sending ‘cultural shockwaves’ on cultural values (Hanson 2013, 4). It has also been considered as offering a critique of globalization, denoting the interrelation between geomorphology and geo-imaginaries upon the cultural surface of the Earth, which is “a turbulent, molten mass with a thin crust” more than it is a unitary sphere that is

firm and fixed, and which makes people “vulnerable to the juddering of plates and the magma currents below” (Hayward 2000, 40). In the context of present study, cultural tectonics is not fundamentally about cultural technological process in their links to the processes of globalization. Here, the concept is subjected to a transformation, in terms of a generalization beyond its particular technological grounding; in turn becomes effected by the earthquake which is an acknowledgement of the loss of an illusory foundation. It comes to circumspect, among others, the construction of culture as well as the culture of construction understood in a broader sense.

0x1.A Miniature Conceptual History of Earthquakes

Deborah Coen notes Nietzsche’s use of metaphor of the earthquake to talk about a concept-quake caused by science, and forms a parallel between the reception of Kurt Gödel’s incompleteness theorems by philosophers like Popper and Menger, who used the metaphor to reflect upon the Gödel’s theorems as bringing about confusion and uncertainty like the impact of an earthquake (Coen 2013, 2). In fact, Nietzsche’s concept-quake itself could be posed as a reception, or indeed as a retrospection, of the Kantian sublime which had developed through Kant’s physical geography and anthropology into his critical philosophy. Commenting on the impact of 1755 Lisbon Earthquake upon Kant’s geoimaginary, so to speak, Passannante writes that for Kant the temporality of the sublime meant that the “the most ordinary experience was full of earthquakes to come” and that the movement of the sublime was compared to a vibration resolving into cancellation, “evoking the image and language of earthquakes” (Passannante 2019, 232-233).

This meta-narrative that figures the Lisbon earthquake as the ground of modern history lays bare an antinomy which creeps within philosophy and science: “Kant founded a modern science of the earth precisely by eliminating the human subject from it” (Coen 2013, 8). The figure-ground reversal enacted by the Lisbon earthquake leads Kant to “discover” the figure-ground reversal as a model of itself, and the sublime as “the rational disposition revealed in the one who judges” (Passannante 2019, 222). However, already in the beginning of 20th century the

anticipative sublime reveals a “Nietzschean master” which looms on the horizon for the European geo-imaginary in retrospection, that comes with a complementary twist on “the seismological fantasy of Immanuel Kant: the earthquake emptied of human content and reduced to a ‘fascinating physics experiment’” (Baelz 1906, 718 as quoted in Coen 2013, 134).

In the first chapter of his *Hyperobjects*, Timothy Morton talks about ‘A Quake in Being’ to describe his ‘discovery’ as “symptoms of a fundamental shaking of being, a *being-quake*” which implies that the “ground of being is shaken” (Morton 2015, 19). Offering a quasi-Heideggerian solution to the Kantian gap between the phenomenon and the thing, one that is derived from the framework of object-oriented ontology; hyperobjects appear as viscous, nonlocal, undulating, phasing and interobjective (Morton 2015, 24). There is an account of various discoveries situated in the beginning of the 20th century, namely by Husserl, by Einstein, and by Planck, each in their own respective ways discover something strange about objects, about the discreteness of experience, of spacetime, or of quanta; yet, somehow all three discoveries confirm the Kantian gap between phenomenon and thing (Morton 2015, 11-14).

Hyperobjects, in their massive scalar disruption of humans in spatial and temporal terms, are responsible for the end of the world, and not in the sense of a coming apocalypse but one that is already happening or has already happened. Morton’s consideration of the end of the world as we know it, begs for the question of *for whom* or *as who knows it*, and the answer to which sounds a lot like *for philosophers*: Humans are still not to be found anywhere. Similar to Kant, Morton gives an account of a disaster in which humans are missing and victims are silent. Although he asserts that the hyperobjects are “more deeply challenging” than disasters (Morton 2015, 16), they enact a forgetting in the image and language of earthquake, as being-quake which cancels seismicity into annihilation, which is indeed “a kind of philosophical amnesia” that enacts a forgetting in terms of the making and burying of the disaster (Passannante 2019, 234) or the displacement of the human and the silencing of the victim.

The symptomatology of a reflexively criminal world subjecting the victim to a double-death once as displaced from the centre and as forgotten, rendered mute and silent (Laruelle 2015, 64), necessitates in posing the criminal world as the same world that has been ending for philosophers; the solution to which does not seem like more philosophy. If earthquakes blend into the mixture that are hyperobjects, they do so as entrapped within a circularity that captures them in a mode of double-articulation. The antinomy of ecology and philosophy receives a philosophical solution in Morton's account, whereas François Laruelle tackles this antinomy by proposing ecology as a new science that undermines the authority of philosophy. Laruelle displaces ecology as an ontological object, and perhaps also it could be said that he displaces philosophy, rather than displacing humanity, and attempts to undo the violence of philosophy by proposing ecology as a new science that rivals philosophy (Laruelle 2021).

If we had tried to trace, perhaps a miniaturized, conceptual history of earthquakes in European geo-imaginary, Laruelle's approach could be noted down as initiating a theory-quake: a presentation that is "according to the quantum operator of the imaginary number" (Laruelle 2021, 5). He poses the theoretical displacement of philosophy by ecology as "the first phase of a massive earthquake" (Laruelle 2021, 7) that is followed by the transformation of ecological rationality based on algebra of complex numbers by creating new concepts and mutating the meaning of the others, which considered as a whole is "an eco-fiction, a new ecological science parallel to science-fiction" (Laruelle 2021, 1), and "fictional insofar as the victims are never its simple objects or subjects, but its conditions and occasions" (Laruelle 2015, 114). The theory-quake considers an algebraic earthquake as the square root of -1, or i , which is a "subtractive work operating on the representative forms of philosophy and breaking their circularity" (Laruelle 2021, 69), which makes it possible to talk in terms of a 'downed' or lowered-over transcendence or subtractive addition that conjugates variables.

0x2.A Non-Dwelling Perspective

If what is at stake here is not so clear, we can proceed with a perspectival shift to bring into the discussion an anthropologist, Tim Ingold, who gives an account of his shift from a building perspective to a dwelling perspective. Ingold's account marks his shift from thinking "according to which worlds are made before they are lived in" to thinking "according to which the forms people build, whether in imagination or on the ground, only arise within the current of their life activities" (Ingold 2000, 154). Offering another quasi-Heideggerian solution to the Kantian gap between phenomenon and thing, Ingold's phenomenological account of dwelling comes to reverse the relationship between building and dwelling, such that the former comes to be encompassed by the latter (Ingold 2000, 185). Heidegger's etymological and existential approach to the relationship between building, dwelling and thinking guides Ingold to adapt the dwelling perspective as a remedy against the antinomies between "evolution and history, and between biology and culture" (Ingold 2000, 186), such that social relations come to be understood as a subset of ecological relations.

Ingold, following Heidegger, 'discovers' that building, that comes to act as a foundation upon which people can dwell, is an illusory foundation because it used to be the other way, the people dwelled in the world so that they could build. There is an affinity to this operation that is in the words of Morton, "what ecological thought must do, then, is unground the human by forcing it back onto the ground" (Morton 2015, 18). Even though Morton and Ingold appear to talk about different things, they seem to talk within an invariant structure. The loss of an illusory foundation in the form of building sounds very much like an effect of an earthquake, but the phenomenological return of the ground sounds like a renewed hallucination, an illusory building hallucinated in the ruins of an older one as a persistent aftershock of an earthquake. "Only because they already dwell therein can they think the thoughts they do" (Ingold 2000, 186) writes Ingold, which leaves one in dismay, wondering the fate of those non-dwelling in Ingold's account; those who are disabled, exiled, displaced, and victimized in a double sense.

Roy Wagner crafts a formula for what he calls as “the true image of a false relationalism” or simply as quasification: “We not only *rationalize*” but also “*rationalize* the fact that we *rationalize*”, overdetermining the effects of modeling and underdetermining our agency (Wagner 2005, 207). All this could reveal is the inversion inherent in modeling, which would amount to a provisional etymology of the word *dwell* counteracting Heidegger’s etymological tracing of *build*, as the former would necessitate its own conceptual history. But as the roots in old English *dwellan* “to lead into error, deceive, mislead”¹ would be so apparent in their intention, we would only go so far as to contemplate on the translation of Heidegger’s *wohnen* into English as *dwelling*. That is, if we remain content in the quasification enacted by Tim Ingold, as in granting a benevolent reading to his phenomenological inflection of dwelling and material vitality, would we too become “initiates in the ‘paradigm’” by consciously being led astray, so that scientific disciplines can “sustain the kind of authoritarian hegemony...that passes for most people” (Wagner 2005, 210)?

Laruelle considers dwelling as “a philosophy materialized in miniatures” where “the simple shelter or the cardboard box of the poorest people changes the concept of housing” (Laruelle 2021, 59). A pre-emptive defence against the criminal world is thinking oriented to non-dwelling, a thought under-determined by victims which impoverishes philosophy by taking its foundation within a collapse, that is “the trace of the universal presence of the imaginary number in every intention and in every causality of representation” (Laruelle 2021, 9). This is akin to putting the world in brackets; suspending the decision philosophy holds upon the living, such as Ingold’s decision of boiling down the individual into “animal-in-its-environment” (Ingold 2000, 186); putting the phenomenological return out of play by a theory-quake in a quasi-experimental way. Any ecological anthropology, that deems itself legitimate to project sufficient reasons for efficient causes, falls into ruins in a shock not anticipatable within its own apparatus of capture; and a pre-emptive defence of the human by thinking oriented to non-dwelling is a struggle against this sufficiency of anthropology.

¹ <https://www.etymonline.com/word/dwell>

Non-dwelling is considered to be an extension of the concept of dwelling so as not to be deceived. It is not against dwelling nor it destroys the concept. It's a thought conditioned by those that are under rubble or within a wreckage. It is not the news, nor the truth, and certainly not an inversion between them. No philosophy, no writing, no photograph and no medium can capture it; they can explicitly or implicitly attempt to account for its lack or excess. Ingold or Morton can attempt to account for the so-called Kantian gap between phenomenon and thing by offering philosophical solutions that are based on "division and synthesis" which warrants their "auto-position as the transcendental loop of conceptual thought: a circular and tautological self-sufficiency" (Louis-Klein 2020, 79). Thinking oriented to non-dwelling, or thought conditioned by those disabled, exiled, displaced and victimized does not content itself with taking a snapshot of ruins which more often than not end up being integrated into the machinery of (re)construction plans; it invents more than it constructs or deconstructs. Its invention is a theory-quake that transforms the articulative protocols of the capture-mode (Wagner 2005, 210), which seeks the immanent cause of justice within the victim by rendering the victim all the more discrete and thus all the less forgettable (Laruelle 2015).

0x3. A Secret Echo

Commenting upon this tautological value system that the scientific industry is, Wagner remarks that "our massed libraries of ethnography and theory are in this respect learned reverberations of vital critical earthquakes" (Wagner 1981, 152). One can invoke that theory-quakes are unlearned echoes that break open or fracture the circularity of enclosed spaces that reverberate the violence inflicted upon the victims. Conceptualization of violence as "roaring, rumbling, grumbling, or murmuring" is also a violence of conceptualization, one that is apparently justified by the persistence of violence in a continuum that vibrates across "spatial, temporal, and material fields" (Navaro-Yashin 2020, 10-11). Reverberation as a relational effect is produced when the sound is reflected through material surfaces within an enclosed space as it persists or prolongs. What distinguishes reverberation from echo is the former's continuity mediated by material surfaces and the confinement of it within an enclosed space as it would have dispersed in an open space; whereas

the latter is said to be more discrete or as “the sharp awareness of repetition” (Harvey 2020, 296).

A tracing of reverb and echo through history and mythology might suggest that the latter is generally a phenomenon of the ‘natural’ world, whereas the former figures as a secondary quality of the built environment: In a sense, there is a connection between “reverberancy” and political power through its seats and sites whether it be sacred or secular; whereas echo often figures as “dispossessed and mocking”, which resonates in their gendered qualities as male voice and female voice (Doyle 2005, 40). Reverb gives space and depth to sound through its multiple reflections on hard material surfaces, gives color or timbre; whereas echo poses an ‘atavistic’ suggestion of animism, in terms of a talking nonhuman world, which in its ambiguity is “an irreconcilable dualism, while simultaneously hinting at a transcendent monism, that all in fact may be at base be one” (Doyle 2005, 39). The confined spaces of temples, mosques, palaces or houses architectonically amplify the sound of the seats or sites of power, but the dispossessed and mocking voice of echo poses a disturbance or a fracture to political speech and transforms it.

Through an analogy with the reverberation of sound, an architectonics of violence is laid bare in the edited volume titled *Reverberations* (Navaro-Yashin et al. 2020). However, when the building collapses what is required by such dynamics is perhaps an “anarchitectonics” that fractures the enclosed space, and diffracts the dispersion of acoustic waves so as to bring about a new echo-logical amplitude. This echo posed in terms of echo-logical dispersion is not an echo in transcendence as in a “sharp awareness of repetition”, which is just a validation of transcendence, but an echo in immanence that is against the double transcendence of auto-position. The sacred or secular spaces of confinement that reverberate the sounds of violence are bound to collapse, which is the presence of the imaginary number that is its essence. Reverberation, understood as the superposition of echoes, is a perception of distortion (Harvey 2020, 296); whereas the diffractive echo-logical dispersion that fractures the confined spaces of violence might be posed as a distortion of perception, which is cognitive estrangement through the theory of cultural tectonics. If it is said to be violent, it is theoretically violent against sufficiency and hierarchy.

What does an earthquake and human speech have in common? Can earth speak, can humans quake? From an undulatory perspective, they both produce waves propagating acoustic energy through various media. From a more particulate perspective, the difference between seismic waves and human voice is the frequency (Hunstad et al. 2013). The elastic body of the earth produces two type of waves that travel through its interior: the primary compressional waves that are longitudinal, and secondary shear waves that are transversal. These waves are superposed as various surface waves characterized by their polarization. Human body, on the other hand, could be argued to produce sound waves that originate “in the contained resonating chambers of the throat and head” and lets out “the inner reverberation into a volume that surrounds” itself (Wagner 2001, 137). In this sense, the mouth acts as the opening which diffracts the superposed echoes within the body towards the surface of experience, as faults diffract the acoustic energy carried to the surface by the body waves of the earth. Perhaps the roaring, grumbling or murmuring as sound analogues of violence is not only metaphors for the reverberation of violence, but also violent echoes diffracted through these openings.

Humans and the world violently resonate like echoes of codes: “Coded-coding, each thing reverberates in every other thing, coding-coded” (Serres, 2010, 135). Could it be the case that sounds originating from the from depths, “the dark bowels of the ground” which has been interpreted as “the words of phantoms coming back” (Serres 2010, 35), only lay bare how human as an earthly being, humanizes earth. This statement figures the human as an aleatory subject or as an aleatory calculation of lived experience: Human and earth are not opposed to one another, they are rather in superposition, as variables lowered to the state of becomings, no longer as quantitative or as fixed essences, “they are affected by the imaginary number and are already non-commutative becomings” (Laruelle 2021,6-7). The secret of echo neither serves for the affirmation of fixation with self, nor for the validation of its division and synthesis, ‘self-knowledge’ or call it a ‘life’; it is more a hearing affected by the imaginary number, a kind of “hearing-in-rhythm” that is an “ecological anticause” in that rhythm is not a matter of metrics or recurrence, but it is identical

to hearing-in-rhythm (Szepanski 2020, 245), or rather it is idempotent ($1+1=1$, one-in-one=one) (Laruelle 2021, 28). To suspend frequency in-rhythm is to enter the field of non-frequency politics which stresses that "the relation between the different speed of waves and the maxima of intensity or timeless degree of different waves" form a dispersion (Szepanski 2020, 248).

Seismopolitics arises from the suspension of frequency that differentiates seismic waves and human sound. If indeed the theory of cultural tectonics poses a distortion of perception, the arising seismopolitics prevents it from becoming another perception. This is because the implications of the suspension of frequency is such that the collapsing gap between active seismic, as 'artificial' seisms, and passive seismic, as 'natural' seisms, disperses into what has been called seismic noise. It is defined as "the undesirable part of seismic data that is not signal, and signal is what fits our conceptual model" (Kumar and Ahmed 2021), whereby the disturbance or failure presupposes a conceptual model that excludes noise and its composition, "thus thinking the real always as a correlate of thought" (Szepanski 2020, 245). The example of such a model can lead one to reassert that "the seismograph is our artificial ear" (Hunstad et al. 2013, 534), which is a statement that can be inverted as 'the ear is a natural seismograph', one that reveals nothing and which seismopolitics makes obsolete as artificial and natural are just vectors for non-commutative becomings of seismograph and ear. Seismic noise is indifferent to models, inversions or modeling processes as it is a generic name for relatively persistent vibration.

"The noise begins the rhythm that smooths out the noise; the rhythm erases the noise that destroys the rhythm" (Serres 2010, 113). This is a statement that could guide us in terms of what is at stake with the considerations of seismic noise and hearing-in-rhythm. We could transform it as the following: Seismic noise originates hearing-in-rhythm, which is a wave carrying itself as a trace for itself, that flattens seismic noise; hearing-in-rhythm traverses seismic noise that disperses hearing-in-rhythm. If we could bring about a concept such as 'generic seismicity' into discussion, its formula would resonate with this remark: "There is indeed a chain of mountains or undulations, but there is also the seismic shift that crosses these

mountains, making them rise and be displaced“ (Laruelle 2009). And if we took the secret of echo seriously, its ‘animism’ that brings forth an irreversible duality and an affective monism, we would arrive at an underdetermined conception of humanity as generic, or human as a probable subject; which is put forth algebraically as $X=\text{human}$ and which renders the human as indefinite (Laruelle 2021). This conception opens up the first phase of our ‘echology’, which is the theory of cultural tectonics and its complementary seismopolitics.

<...finds oneself in an action... an action one had not even dared to think before... how does a human find oneself in an action? Does a human find oneself in an action that has not crossed one’s dreams? No, such a thing cannot happen. At least in a situation that one has planned or that does not exceed one’s imagination, a human can preserve one’s mental and spiritual strength. Human... human... who is this human? Human is a generic name, it can be used under various conditions to refer to a variety of individuals. Instead of ‘human’, you can also call it ‘X’. If it could be called ‘X’, I would be feeling myself very happy about this assumption. Because I am a mathematician and in my current situation, all I hope to see is what has happened to me as consisting of solvable functions of an unknown ‘X’. As such, numerous nightmares will have never happened...(Atay 1998, 19)>

1.OSCILLATIONS

<...It was some time ago when I was following the same gestures that are present in the writing of these words, clicks and breaks that compose a fragment of chaos, that do not have so much harmony but perhaps a trace of stress of the beat in rhythm. I was maybe sowing the seeds of what will have become this present study, as I was writing my ‘motivation’ for pursuing a degree in Leuven in an anticipative manner. I was oscillating in retrospection when suddenly a persistent high-pitched voice scattered my attention and reassembled it in her movement as it was approaching me. As we exchanged ‘winks’ with the cat, she had bumped her head to my leg, swinging her tail across my leg and then making another high-pitched persistent sound as she proceeded on the wooden tiles, which had dispersed into the room, eventually settling on the floor in her silence. Little did I know when I didn’t even

think too seriously about this rather ordinary interaction, as I tried to regain my attention on my writing.

The noisy silence in the room receded and what filled the moment was the initial jolt of the quake that hit like a kick from below and raised us on our feet. In sheer catalepsy, our gazes found each other like our legs searching for the floor they were standing upon. What followed was the shear waves oscillating with us in the deep resonance of our look exchange. In this second look, I recalled an earlier moment, that had raise me up but did not make me think: the cat had been looking down from a window which opens to a critical height which was quite unusual for her as that window wasn't open most of the time. I remember seeing it from afar, and fearing on her behalf; getting up, walking to the cat to fold her up and close the window. I didn't think too seriously about this interaction until this second look. Could the cat be saying 'I told you so' in this second look? Certainly not, as that would be wrong not once but twice. But my feeling that I did not miss one but two 'clues' in her 'anticipation' of the seism says a lot about my understanding and says nothing about the cat's; whereas in retrospect, my 'motivation' in anticipation of this study calls forth a movement of thought as the trace for a thought of movement, say, from Istanbul to Leuven...>

1x0. From Canonical Formula to Inverted Ethnography

Having laid down the main axes and a certain layer of concepts that are operative in the approach this study follows, which is a technical first step in our procedure; we are now moving to the discuss the generation of fields upon which our concepts operate. What is guiding our endeavor here, as we were only hinting at it thus far, is the canonical formula of Claude Levi-Strauss for the structural analysis of myth " $\langle fx(a):fy(b)::fx(b):fa^{-1}(y) \rangle$ " (Levi-Strauss 1955). What is peculiar about this formula is that it is not a mere metaphor or a rhetorical device, but "one can simultaneously apprehend the formula as a conceptual relation and see it, here and there in the world, stamped in a geometry that human endeavour has envisioned" (Levi-Strauss 2001, 29). There are two functions in the formula, 'fx' and 'fy', that "represent the irreconcilable oppositions" as vectors, which actualize the

terms 'a' and 'b', through which the term 'b' becomes the operator that mediates the mechanism and generates "a double twist" (Maranda 2001, 4). 'a' is inverted to become a function of 'y', that gets actualized as the term expressed by the function (a-1). In order to echo, if not to reiterate, what has been discussed in [0x3] regarding earthquakes and human speech, we could see the workings of the formula for ourselves:

$f_{quake}(earth):f_{speech}(human)::f_{quake}(human):f_{earth-1}(speech)$

which would read as 'the earthquake is to the human speech as the human-quake is to the inverted earth function of the speech'. The term 'human' appears as the mediating center that operates in the inversion of the term 'earth' and the actualization of the speech function. Or conversely, we could try to work the statement 'the seismograph is our artificial ear' through the formula:

$f_{artificial}(seismograph):f_{natural}(ear)::f_{artificial}(ear):f_{seismograph-1}(natural)$

'the artificial seismograph is to the natural ear as the artificial ear is to the inverted seismographic function of the natural'. The ear is the mediator that acts in the inversion of the term 'seismograph' and the actualization of the natural function to become the term 'natural' for the inverted seismographic function. The canonical formula of Levi-Strauss has inspired various strands of thought such as the Melanesian ethnography, or the so-called ontological turn in anthropology. For example, Mosko discusses a variant of the formula that can be applied to myth and non-myth, for a structural study of ethnographic data that is narrative and non-narrative. This eliminates the double or the additional twist by reformulating the formula as " $\langle f_x(a):f_y(b)::f_x(b):f_y(a) \rangle$ ", which moves by a 'recursive inversion' that retains an analogical expression while also retaining the non-linearity of myth without the double twist. For him, the problem lies with the additional twist of the inverted function (-1) of the final member which is "a product of the 'transcendental deductions' among myths of different cultures" (Mosko 1991, 146). Whereas, in his interpretation of the formula Mosko sees sociocultural systems as totalities, and if

these total systems as units can be demonstrated to structure around a single formula, then systematic comparison is possible (Mosko 1991, 147).

In other words, Mosko's variant builds a symmetrical relationship between two sides which sees the variables as "in a commutative group in which every element has order two" (Morava 2001, 56-57). But as Wagner also suggests, the recursive step stays on the surface if it is a mere validation of reality "wherein the means of representation and the facticity of the represented echo one another" (Wagner 2001, 211). This is particularly resonant with Martin Holbraad's discussion of the 'metarecursive step' in which the argument has three steps, partly based on Wagnerian notion of invention. Put very broadly, these steps are the following: First, anthropological difference is assumed by the anthropologist; second, the 'field' reveals a contradiction of these assumptions by ethnographic alterity; third, a recursive inversion of 'culture' as invention, where third step is the argument standing on its own as an anthropological invention. As a whole, this is not a logical necessity but a strategic move as "any contradiction" between the assumption of anthropological difference and ethnographic description could do" (Holbraad 2012, 237-259). Sounds like a single formula for an anthropologist to reinvent the truth, and the truth is reinvention of anthropology in its self-relation.

Wagner remarks that there is a need "to 'justify' the ratio between the two conditions set forth by Lévi-Strauss for the canonic formula by 'drawing them' to the scale of the expression they describe" (Wagner 2001, 226), which is akin to a matrix that is a kind of drawing, one that has "the advantage that it can be algebraically manipulated to reveal higher-order structural properties" (Hage and Array 1983, 6). We could say that Wagner's fractal person, as a totality that is neither individual nor group (Wagner 1991, 163), acts as the justification of the ratio between two sides of the canonical formula, which is the application of fractality to anthropology, one that is generating recursivity. In the variant of Mosko, this can be put as the following:

falterity(ethnography):ffractality(anthropology)::falterity(anthropology):ffractality(ethnography)

We could ask just what has changed in the inversion between the canonical formula, which would have posed the last term and function as fethnography-1(fractality). And it is where recursivity comes in, as the inverted ethnographic function of fractality is transformed into the fractality function of ethnography. We could say that the canonical formula variant keeps things open, or untotalizable, as in granting the term 'fractality' an inverted ethnographic function. But inserted into the Mosko's variant we can see this function as the fractality function of ethnography or the self-scaling of ethnography that is 'any contradiction'. It is as if the anthropologist goes on a field to hear the reverberation of his self-resonance which is kind of "an established resonance between different orders of representation" one that is considered as "the representation of representation" (Wagner 2001, 211). It fears it will drown itself in the time lag implied by this resonance, if it gives an ear to the simplest echo or gives up its dualism.

We could imagine a scenario in which an anthropologist is 'conducting' a fieldwork with a device called the 'ethnograph' that records the reflections on the field. The field is structured in a such a way, or at least the account of it is given in such a way, that everyone speaking including the anthropologist is recorded, to give the impression that the ethnograph will record any voice neutrally, and then the anthropologist is assumed to sample these field recordings by reflexively justifying the positionality on the field to rescue 'a sense of proportion' (Wagner 2005, 248). But what is inside this ethnograph, is a Wagnerian human bat that is only able to echolocate 'referents' that resonate with the frequencies of the anthropologist's voice which is the 'meaningfulness' of direction in his terms (Wagner 2001, 135-137), or the self resonant frequency. All the other frequencies are rendered as 'ethnographic noise' or the undesirable part of ethnographic data. The symbolic obviation of the argument is the argument's self-grounding as a 'chiasmus', where anthropologist invents culture that comes to stand on its own, or at least next to 'anthropology', itself a self-standing entity, one that captures the ethnographic alterity to transform itself and invent culture through the fractality of ethnography.

Whereas, we find it more apt to consider the inverted ethnographic function of fractality; which, in retrospect, can account for the autonomy of anthropology

without its closure upon itself, as well as rescuing ethnography from being a self-scaling device of the anthropologist, granting its own autonomy. Perhaps it is not 'culture' that must be invented to get elevated next to anthropology; rather, it is anthropology which should be brought down, rid of its sufficiency, to inhere next to ethnography. To 'inhere' is not to divide and synthesize, as if ethnography and anthropology are oppositional terms; in-here is the priority of 'in-sistence' that links them to Earth, before the decision that divides and synthesizes to link them to World as 'ex-sistence' (Laruelle 2021). The World is a self-resonant chamber that reverberates violence for which elevated anthropology and culture sounds like a 'scientific exology' or a science of closure, whereas the inherent stress in the pulse between ethnography and anthropology calls for a 'radical echology' that arises as an impulse, or an in-pulse (Szepanski 2020, 249). This pulse does not belong to ethnography nor anthropology, nor it is an established resonance between the two.

As we have shown in [0x3], the suspension of frequency in-rhythm allows us to move beyond the opposition of these irreconcilable dualisms by considering them as vectors in superposition, describing non-commutative becomings. Rather than opposing a variety of functions, we could pose a wave function that superposes non-commutative variables. Rhythm is hearing-in-rhythm if we suspend frequency, as this operation is idempotent such that hearing adds nothing to rhythm, since rhythm originates in the random of indifferent noise. In other words, we are at 'fault' if we try to trace the echo in the flow of time, since 'time' itself can be an echo in a commutative space. Perhaps we can demonstrate the crux of the argument in showing its relation with Johannes Fabian's idea about the fundamental contradiction between ethnographic fieldwork and the anthropological knowledge in terms of how anthropology constructs its object, the 'Other', which in temporal terms amounts to a denial of coevalness to this 'Other', which is interpreted as anthropology's allochronic discourse or its schizogenic use of time (Fabian 2014).

1x1. From Ethnographic Present to Third-Person's Perspective

Fabian's deconstruction of time in anthropological discourse attempts to reveal how anthropological knowledge is in contradiction with ethnographic fieldwork in terms

of its use of temporality. Whereas in the fieldwork, the anthropologist and its cultural other are in a coeval and dialogical relationship that operates in an intersubjective temporality which is shared as the locus of anthropological knowledge; the anthropologist denies this coevalness to its other, that is the object of the study, by rendering this other as non-subjects by using pronouns and verbs in third person which “mark an Other outside the dialogue” (Fabian 2014, 85). Fabian traces a tendency in ethnographic description as the use of present tense, which he calls as the ethnographic present, which is “the practice of giving accounts of other cultures and societies in the present tense” (Fabian 2014, 82). As the anthropologist assumes this first person point of view, the writing addresses the second person which is perhaps other anthropologists or scientific community, while the third person as cultural other is muted or cannot speak. This is simply not coincidental or accidental as in marking a literary genre of ethnography, but “a choice of expression which is determined by an epistemological position” which reveals a cognitive stance that “presupposes the givenness of the object of anthropology as something to be observed” (Fabian 2014, 86).

"Method is expected to yield objective knowledge by filtering out experiential 'noise' thought to impinge on the quality of information. But what makes a (reported) sight more objective than a (reported) sound, smell, or taste? Our bias for one and against the other is a matter of cultural choice rather than universal validity" (Fabian 2014, 108).

The critical question with Fabian is indeed how to account for this experiential noise, and his solution points to a dialectical resolution that synthesizes the relationship between the autobiographic past and the ethnographic present as reflexion, which renders anthropology as a hermeneutic activity that interprets the experience of the ethnographer positioned in the field. In a sense, field is the coeval space and anthropology must recognize this coevalness which ethnography presupposes but the anthropologist denies by reflectively hiding the subjectivity. In order to rescue this coevalness and the intersubjective time, a first step is “to recuperate the idea of totality” (Fabian 2014, 156). Then, Fabian turns towards Marx to rescue a sense of proportion after perhaps sounding too Hegelian and claims that the allochronic

discourse of anthropology remains an idealist position and that includes all materialisms; whereas he offers to think of a sensuous nature which ties consciousness “as an activity to the production of meaningful sound” insofar as this “involves the labor of transforming, shaping matter” (Fabian 2014, 161). Consciousness is the realization of the production of meaningful sound, a fully speaking and hearing Self that overcomes the contradiction of cultural difference; it is a kind of unification of anthropology and ethnography such that awareness is predicated upon hearing meaningful sounds that are produced by self and other.

For Fabian, then, perhaps time is indeed an echo given the commutativity of intersubjective time “for the temporality of speaking implies cotemporality of producer and product, speaker and listener, Self and Other” (Fabian 2014, 164). The resonance between the speaker and the listener is pure meaning as it cancels any noise, or it cancels into noise; for Fabian is either too quick or too late to assume that the act of speaking produces a being listened-to or even a heard, let alone any understanding. If the Wagnerian ethnographic device had an echo-locating human bat inside, Fabian’s has an eternal clock that swings between the temporal rhythm of the knower and the known which is its ‘self-relation’, self-resonance or self-standing. Fabian brings the fetishization of ethnography up to its transcendental limit, forms an analogy between speaking of the other without backing up and the inflationary printing of money, and then wonders where has its meaning gone: “What, to stay with the metaphor of inflation, would be the gold that gives the conceptual paper money circulating in discourses about the other its value?” (Fabian 2014, 181). The auto-referential abstraction or the full automation of anthropological knowledge coupled with the coeval force of the ethnographic here and now, from which it extracts its meaning and which it dissolves, perhaps as money does away with commodity to beget more money: M-C-M’ or Anthropology-Ethnography-Anthropology’ to M-M’ or A-A’.

We are pursuing here the structural homology, as explained by Kolozova, between philosophy, capitalism, and patriarchy as tautological value exchange systems that erect value as self-standing through the destruction of materiality (Kolozova 2020); extending this homology into the anthropology’s seizure of materiality which

succumbs human to a communicative rationality in a society, tied to the demands of 'produce now' or 'consume now', which is the same side of the same coin, 'communicate now', that cannot flip to its other side. For the issue lies not on the side of anthropology, nor the ethnographic device as they are not opposed, but their functioning as a signifying automaton that abstracts value or meaning as self-standing. It is as if we not only render noise meaningful, but also make that meaning stand on its own; which is of course a hallucination, if not entirely visualist in Fabian's sense but also an auditory hallucination. Without conceiving a dialectical relationship or any synthesis that grants a coherence, Kolozova considers the relation between the signifying automaton (language) and physicality (matter) as unilateral, which makes the conception a radical dyad: "a dyad is radical insofar as its components are not determined by the relation of one of the elements to the other but rather by the real, inside the dyad and the real of the dyad itself as determining materiality" (Kolozova 2020, 5). 'Noise' is the real of the dyad, it is indifferent to meaning but it unilaterally determines meaning according to the materiality of the real. Noise is radically foreclosed to thought, it is the impenetrable kernel of non-sense which makes it impossible to be 'overcome', whereas we can proceed with affirming its foreclosure.

Kolozova finds in Marx but also in Laruelle an affinity to think from a 'third person's perspective', to make oneself an object for a third person as well as to postulate the determination of thought by materiality as the real, which doesn't grant the overcoming of this duality but of diminishing this tendency of philosophy as philosophy is too quick to announce to have overcome the contradiction it takes as a given: "The science of the species being of humanity postulates all reality, including the subjective, as object of investigation and, therefore, the thought as objective. This type of objectivity is placed beyond the subject-object dialectics" (Kolozova 2020, 26). This eliminates the need for any dialectics between the autobiographic past and the ethnographic present as it does away with the opposition of doing and saying through a superposition; such that thinking can trace or submit to the "syntax of the real" and give a descriptive account of its structure as a "minimal transcendental" or minimum use of philosophy which is called the operation of 'cloning' (Kolozova 2020, 39; Laruelle 2021, 87). This cloning operation

does not condition thought into a cancellation or an annihilation into noise; our clones are echoes as material conceptions that submit to noise without attempting to account for its meaning or becoming one with its essence; they are under-determined as material instances by the real.

One can evince a double-slit experiment analogue in fieldwork, in which the anthropologist conducts an experiment with the ethnographic device as a recorder: whenever any observation, measurement, or valuation is effectuated, there appears a 'collapse' in the wave function which reveals the observation effect. This ethnographic device can only ask 'which way', or can't record the position and the momentum, or the location and the intention at the same time; to which the anthropologist reacts by attributing to oneself this observation effect, as in giving time or echoing time to oneself. Thus, an anthropologist like Ingold can talk about 'participant-observation' as an ontological commitment in terms of "a fulfillment, in both letter and deed, of what we owe to the world for our development and formation" (Ingold 2014, 388). Ingold's commitment here echoes that of a property owner's, who has come to ask for what's essentially theirs in seeking their fair share of rent from the tenants who are perhaps the other participants that cannot make observations, or whose observations are transitive, melting into anthropological value. Their participation, and their observations are rewarded by the anthropologist who reasserts the value of anthropology as a gratitude for their taking part in the anthropologist's little thought experiment.

1x2. From Self-Resonance to Fractal Identity

What we have diagnosed as 'self-resonance' has also been observed in an article by Adam Louis-Klein, where he discusses the anthropological extension of non-philosophy. He observes that there is a transcendental arithmetic of self-relation or double transcendence, which can be called a $3/2$ or a $2/3$ structure of philosophy and which also extends into the relation of anthropological comparison, depending on whether the synthesis by thought is termed explicitly or performed implicitly (Louis-Klein 2020). Through a symptomatic reading of Vivieros de Castro's and Descola's, respectively explicit and implicit, synthesis by anthropological thought;

Louis-Klein reveals how the position of the anthropologist gets doubled: As the anthropologist not only produces the relations but also “attempts to determine the common horizon of its two objects”, which are the anthropologist and the native (Louis-Klein 2020, 81). Instead of overdetermining the effects of anthropological comparison, he attempts to develop a certain kind of symmetrization which renders the western and the non-western discourses as “inverse variants of each other, thus in a non-hierarchical relation of equality“ (Louis-Klein 2020, 82).

Through crafting a sort of non-structuralism, the novelty of ‘ontologies’ in the so-called ontological turn, as in the perspectivism of Vivieros de Castro or the naturalistic taxonomy of Descola, are reduced to “local transcendentals which possess relative autonomy as clones of the One“; a relative autonomy that is derived from the “the Other as limit” or the Stranger which is “the Other seen-in-immanence, the Other which we immanently ‘are’” (Louis-Klein 2020, 89). The relatively autonomous local transcendentals resonates with our discussion of a non-dwelling perspective [0x2] which can be called “stranger-perspectives as clones of human immanence“ (Louis-Klein 2020, 89) or what we have been calling as immanent “echoes“ [0x3]. Louis-Klein considers this as the ‘unified theory of anthropology and philosophy’, whose descriptions are ‘anthro-fictions’ of generic humanity, that are singularities subtracted from the relation of universal-particular and that conceives a “*fractal identity*” between these local transcendentals rather than a “*containment hierarchy*” (Louis-Klein 2020, 89). There is no dialectic between the global and the local, or the macro and the micro as they are considered to be identical in the last instance to the One, which is the Real determined by materiality.

It should be noted that the fractal identity of local transcendentals as echoes of human immanence do not amount to a “holographic totalization of the conceptual world” which is put forward as the “replication of fractality in the ethnographer’s understanding” (Wagner 1991, 171). Ethnography is not a mere self-scaling device of the anthropologist, and the anthro-fictions are not holographic metaphors in which the natives interpret the relationship that ends in the anthropologist’s reinterpreting this interpretation. This is why we have found it important to stress the inverted ethnographic function of fractality, as there is no glimpse of totalization in

our account. We axiomatically posed the radical foreclosure of noise to both the anthropologist and the native, meaning neither the anthropologist nor the native has any indirect epistemic access to noise in terms of its representation, albeit still being under-determined by noise. We do not proceed from the rules of grammar and then lay down our axioms; we proceed with an axiom first and then follow the syntax of the real as a descriptive account conditioned by its foreclosure. The effects of such a conception is a symmetrization, or a flattening, which can conceive the 'field' as simultaneously a scalar field and a vectorial field such that non-commutative becomings as discrete lived experiences, echoes, can give rise to vectors in superposition.

The anthropologist does not hold the elevated position in devising this field with its assumption of difference, to be confronted by ethnographic alterity which leads the anthropologist to invent the relation between oneself and its other. We hold that the ethnographic alterity is not something to be encountered in the field extended outwards, but it is the stranger that lives within us, the stranger that we immanently are: Ethnographic alterity is not a 'given' that is transformed by synthesis or unification, it is a given in the sense that there is no synthesis or unification but rather that 'we' are given to it as unified or identical to it in the last instance. The absolutization or the totalization of the self-resonance of the anthropologist is a means for an accelerationist politics that suits the imperative of growth which proliferates knowledge and hierarchy amongst multitudes of people and chains them to the reign of capital; whereas what we offer is a de-absolutized degrowth of philosophical and anthropological knowledge by ridding the sufficiency implicit or explicit out of these kinds of knowledge.

The scalar field we mentioned above is what grants the identity in the last instance of local transcendentals to the One, that is, their fractal identity; as well as granting the vectorial field we conceive a single wave function rather than two or multiple functions. The superposition of terms in our immanent matrix is not a re-localization of these terms in a commutative fashion, but it rather poses a single vector for two linear motions. Superposition and non-commutativity are terms Laruelle derives from quantum physics, but this formalism is not used in a folded manner to synthesize

philosophy and physics as a simple fusion, or a dialectical relationship between the two; rather, the challenge quantum mechanics poses upon the classical logic is embraced by Laruelle as 'collisions' rather than a relation of the unity of opposites, which is 'the dialectic':

"Superposition is the form or principle of knowledge, its formalist factum or its existence as reality of science; it comes within the order of knowledge before the quantum, which is its material cause. As for non-commutativity, it is an essential trait that is derived from the quantum, its equivalent, since on the one hand the quantum is the index of the minimal existence of a material for science... and, on the other hand, it is split in its theoretical usage between two variables with inverse products." (Laruelle 2017, 166)

This consideration of superposition is a substitution for the idea of totality, whereas non-commutativity is inspired by Heisenberg's quantum postulate with its formula as $[p, q] = pq - qp = i\hbar$ (where p and q are observables, p the position and q the momentum of a particle, i being the imaginary number and $\hbar$ is the Planck constant) which is the origin of the non-commutative geometry. The Planck constant is considered as the generic constant of the lived experience, which is the "minimum limit that cannot be exceeded, it signals the discreteness of human life and so of all life" (Laruelle 2021, 101). The quantum formalization in Laruelle is a philosophical analog of the uncertainty principle in physics, which does away with the deterministic conceptions of metaphysics; it can perhaps be seen as in a dialogue with Levi-Strauss' canonical formula.

1x3. From Measurement to Decoherence

Perhaps the most famous and much easier illustration of the paradoxical nature of quantum superposition is the thought experiment of Schrödinger which involves a cat and a mechanism, that is made up of a radioactive substance whose probable decay triggers the release of a poisonous gas that could kill the cat, placed in a box without a window and then sealed. The paradox reveals the measurement problem which lies at the heart of the interpretations of quantum mechanics that poses the

problem of cat's being alive and/or dead until the box is opened and an observation is made. At the end of *Tristes Tropiques* (1955), Levi-Strauss ends with the remark "in the wink of an eye, heavy with patience, serenity, and mutual forgiveness, that sometimes, through an involuntary understanding, one can exchange with a cat", which can seemingly enable us to grasp the essence of human species beyond thought and beneath society (Levi-Strauss 1955, 398). Levi-Strauss' ending remarks also sound like an homage to the famous cat of Schrödinger's.

This problem of 'observation' could also be argued to bring us to the heart of the problem in ethnographic observation: Could the 'natives' be behaving the way do because they are being observed? If any observation changes the state of a given system, we could argue that there is no 'neutral' observation as in we cannot know what the natives' intentions are if we know their location or we cannot know where they stand on a given issue if we know what their intentions are. The collapse of the wave function or the wave packet reduction does not really make sense because we cannot say "at which moment the actualization of some products of knowledge out of all possible vectors or virtual observables, that is, generic quantum potentials or potentialities, takes place" (Läwen 2020, 131). A measurement just replaces a virtual observable by an actual observable which grants the irreducibility of generic quantum states to classical states of physical phenomena. The collapse or the reduction of the wave packet only makes 'sense' if we try to approximate the superposition from a perspective in 'coherence', after perhaps a measurement has been made.

This 'coherence' is the anthropologist's echoing time to oneself as in 'conducting' a fieldwork experiment and then proceeding to refer to time in the reduction of observation as well as the attribution of the measurement to oneself. Anthropologist is the figure that opens the sealed box, to check whether the cat is dead or alive, so as to gain an involuntary understanding through its exchange of winks with the cat; there is a sense of going to far away places and making them near while making what is near seem so far away in a sort of chiasmistic crossing, or the so-called ethnographic journey. The journey involves the crossing of borders and giving a 'coherent' account of the encounter with ethnographic alterity which is already

assumed by the anthropologist. We could ask whether the anthropologist *actually* meets its cultural other, or rather this journey is devised as a sort of self-discovery, meeting the stranger-within out in the field and giving a 'coherent' account of this discovery in an ironic manner.

This phase of our study, the theory of cultural tectonics and complementary seismopolitics, has seen the discussion of our concepts, introduced in the beginning, in their resonance with anthropological knowledge and ethnographic theory; while we did not primarily deal with earthquakes here, we rather 'tested' the conceptualizations offered in the beginning against the backdrop of ethnography and anthropology. Considered together, these two phases make up sort of a guide or a map in terms of how to 'read', 'listen' or 'navigate' the upcoming phases. Our echology takes a less abstract shape as we proceed with weaving or suturing elements from the field, which in whole is considered as a fiction.

<...Right after I finished this quasi-vignette(-are you really, unironically calling this a quasi-vignette? -believe me, it sounds much better in Turkish (vinyetimsi)) it was already midnight, and I tried to get a few hours of sleep before I wake up to another day full of thesis writing. After perhaps a couple hours of uneasy sleeping, I woke up and proceeded with my morning routine which involves more coffee and more thesis writing in front of the screen and the control board that is keyboard: more clicks and more breaks. This ritualistic setting was interrupted by a phone call and on the other side of the line, my friend from Istanbul. This friend is the cat's new companion for they share a flat together, and our communication involves a lot of discussion about how the cat is doing, what she is doing, perhaps a couple of videos and photographs from time to time; him calling was not something that was extraordinary, so I picked up the phone without second guessing what it could be about.

-Hey, how are you doing?

-Not much, same old story; working on my thesis still... What's up with you?

-Brother, I'm not feeling very good

-What happened, what's wrong?

-The cat... she fell off the window... I don't exactly know how it happened... You know my place has the mosquito nets on the windows, but one of them was out of place and you know very well that I am very sensitive about closing the windows before sleeping... But last night I fell asleep with the window open, and when I woke up I could not find her around... I went down to the street and shouted for her... she heard me and meowed back... she was in a restaurant's backyard which was locked... I jumped over the door and found her with her mouth covered in blood... She was responsive and came onto my lap but I was very scared probably as she also was... I called the fire department and the police to get them to help me by unlocking the door I climbed over... But they were not taking it very seriously... So I had a heated discussion with them over the phone which involved a lot of cursing and shouting... Eventually, I got some cop to help me by bringing a portable ladder... I handed her to the cop and then we immediately went to a veterinary clinic...

I bursted into tears, sobbing, gasping, groaning, lamenting... This whole thesis feels so utterly pointless, stupid, nonsense, bullsh-t... I don't know how I can proceed or why I should keep writing... I lost all sense of direction... any crumble of motivation... all fell off through a window that I knew very well to have closed... my fear... did I cause this?... did I affect the cat in any way?... is her falling off my fault?... I don't know... What I know is that I don't want to keep on writing... To hell with academia, to hell with anthropology, to hell with this thesis...>

2.ON QUAKING GROUNDS

2x0. Axiom and Method

=ilim ilim bilmektir, ilim kendin bilmektir=

ilim=science, knowledge

bilmek(tir)=(is) to know

kendin=self, oneself, (by) yourself

=knowledge is to know science, knowledge is to know oneself=
=science is to know knowledge, science is to know oneself=
=knowledge is to know knowledge, science is to know oneself=
=science is to know science, knowledge is to know oneself=

The aphorism that was in the epigraph is the axiom of this study. It is attributed to the 13th century Anatolian folk poet Yunus Emre. It is an enigmatic statement, one that is impossible to accurately translate into English. Yet this impossibility is not a restrictive impossibility; it is considered here as an enabling impossibility. In a single gesture, it anticipates the whole of our discussion in the preceding phases, from the canonical formula of Levi-Strauss to Laruelle's non-standard philosophy. Its ambiguity arises from the word *ilim*, which can be translated as both science and knowledge. The conjugations that this ambiguous word gives birth to is attempted to be laid down above, but the conjugations are certainly not limited to the ones we have taken note of. The axiomatization of this statement is our safeguard against the axiomatic logic of capital that erects meaning as self-resonant while destroying brute materiality; whereas our axiom is an immanent echo of folk poetry tradition in Anatolia that is conditioned by the 'common people' against the ornate tradition of Divan poetry, which is the language and art form of the courtly affairs. The axiom that is in a different language than the one the discussion here follows also points to an obstacle in our dealings here which is the problematic issue of translation.

Arising from this axiom, our method is an echo of a Turkish novelist and engineer, Oğuz Atay, which he describes in his famous book *Tutunamayanlar*, that has been translated into English as *The Disconnected*. Yet already after our epigraph, we have attempted to translate a part of his last unfinished book *Eylembilim (Action-science)* in which he speaks as a mathematician, who tries to see what has happened to him "as consisting of solvable functions of an unknown 'X'" (Atay 1998, 19), which is what he equates with 'human'. If we have gone over various thinkers in the preceding phases, being sympathetic to Levi-Strauss' structuralism and Laruelle's non-standard philosophy, being critical of certain others; our axiom and our method that is being explained here makes our engagement with their concepts redundant, in the sense that the account that we are giving here need not really resonate with

their works. Just as we have observed a non-structuralist account, we could speak of a non-Laruellian non-philosophy through Yunus Emre and Oğuz Atay, who can be considered as non-philosophers in their own right. The shift from a theory that is critical of Western prejudices, or Greco-Judaic transcendence in Laruelleian parlance, towards theories, novels, or poems that are more 'native', seems more appropriate for the account we are giving here.

In *Tutunamayanlar*, our protagonist Turgut receives the news that his friend Selim has committed suicide and left Turgut a letter; and we follow Turgut throughout the book as he delves into Selim's writings, as well as his own memories and encounters with common acquaintances while becoming all the more disconnected as he goes deeper into this rabbit hole. The part that is particularly important for our attention here is a theory Turgut explains to Selim called the 'The Coordinates of Life', which is an invention of Turgut. He calls his invention an *ilim-hayal*, which can be translated as science(knowledge)-imagination, or more crudely as science fiction, and explains 'The Coordinates of Life' as "An introduction to the explanation of what a person does, wherever, whenever and however he is, according to the principles of analytic geometry" (Atay 2012, 68). Turgut calls his theory a 'vile', 'based' or 'damned' explanation, and asks himself "why are there coordinates of points, lines, curves... but not coordinates of a more perfect being, the human being, and of life, which is an inseparable part of the human" and then he proceeds to demonstrate his 'spiritual hunger' for knowledge by drawing a coordinate system on a piece of paper (Atay 2012, 70).

...If we know what a human being has done at a certain time, in a certain place and under certain conditions, the curves of the equations written on the basis of these known facts, i.e. the predetermination of the dimensions of motion and time, and whose constant coefficients are determined by the designated characteristics of that human being, drawn according to the time variable, show us what that human being will do in the future and under which conditions... (Atay 2012, 72)

But after this explanation, Selim intervenes and asks Turgut about which sign system will be used for this equation of human life and with what transformation the

coefficients of the known factors in a person would be evaluated. Turgut answers that if we turn this theory into a 'vile' practice, we need to find a system that will display all human knowledge in algebraic notations to express the biological, psychological and sociological conditions of human beings with algebraic signs; so that we can substitute words with numerical values and grammatical combinations with transcendental equations (Atay 2012, 73). Following the axiom and method which is more suited to our native sensibilities here, we will be transforming the '*ilim-hayal*' or '*bilim-kurgu*' (science-fiction) of Turgut into an '*insan-kurgu*' (anthro-fiction) that will also be a '*ev-kurgu*' (eco-fiction). The fascination or perhaps the abuse of ancient Greek roots such as 'anthropos' or 'eco' by the English language need not be taken as given. There is a sense of objection that is considered in these transformations to translating 'anthropology' into Turkish as '*antropoloji*' or 'ecology' as '*ekoloji*', whereas '*insan-bilim*' (human-science) and '*ev-bilim*' (house-science) would sound much more powerful and much more resonant in the Turkish language.

2x1. Biography of an Ordinary Anthropologist

<If the earth can be thought as screaming, then the seismographs are there to record it. Yet, the disasters which we deem too natural, are in fact social in their consequences and their conditions of possibility. This insight is rooted in my childhood, as early as three years old: The 1999 Marmara Earthquake devastated my home, a year after my father had died. The only place to stay we had been left with, was my mother's village where I had spent the initial years of my childhood. My mother's family, along with the whole of the village, were muhajirs, migrant muslims who had come from Abkhazia in the Caucasus. This extraordinary chain of events have positioned me in a culturally heterogenous milieu. The people of the village communicated in a mixed language, predominantly Abkhazian with a couple of Turkish words thrown in. Through years of being present in that cultural conversation, I had developed an understanding of the language and the cultural setting, attending and observing the rituals. Yet, the question that was beginning to shape out of the ambivalent feeling regarding my position in this broad cultural context persisted over years. My filial relations would only allow me to assume the role of the "nephew" of the Abkhazians, yet I was very much growing to adapt to the cultural ethos.>

This is an excerpt that is taken from the motivation letter that was sent to KU Leuven to apply for the Social and Cultural Anthropology master's program. In a sense, it is a biographical note that gives vent to the motivation for choosing to study such a program, detecting the seeds of anthropological inspiration sown into the childhood. It is an anticipatory note that has shaped the current study. Without even going through the professional education, there are glimpses of what was thought to make up anthropological knowledge. Looking back, it sounds very naive in its emulation of what could be deemed as an anthropologist's autobiographical past. It feels very much like an exclamation that expresses a statement such as this: *Ethnography is not a self-scaling device that belongs to professional anthropologists... Here I am, a non-anthropologist making ethnographic observations without even going through professional training.*

<I stand here in front of this building, yet again after 17 years. It is the 'Earthquake Culture Museum' that is located in the center of my hometown, Adapazarı, which had been wrecked by an earthquake in 1999. The main structure of the building is concrete, which is shaped to give the impression of a collapsed building with sharp edges that are irregularly skewed. There are inclined columns that support the main structure of the building, which are seemingly placed in a random manner, and which keep the building standing. Going down a few steps by the stairs and in through the entrance, which is a rather small door that is part of a larger glass structure made up of rectangular PVC windows; a security guard, who is the only other person in the building with me, asks me to sign the visitor book. A poem from a local poet that is on the wall in front, welcomes me and it reads:

*'...the clouds arrived like shrouds, in piles
Wives and children, roses and leaves,
Suddenly laid down to death
An arm over there, a leg, a shoe,
A pair of eyes: hopping around
Here's Turkey: a handful of bareness...'*

A strange feeling of fleeting time fills me up akin to how the ground moves and shakes the earth beneath my feet. It is the obscure mixture of dampness and years of neglect I inhale through my nostrils, which is not how I remember my first time being here. A small pupil in primary school, excitedly walking between these corridors among my peers, a group of children that have just moved from tent cities to the school a couple of years ago. The photographs, so many photos that adorn these moist walls and portray the shared traumatic experience of the earthquake; I am once again struck by the sheer nakedness of this atrocity, the violent brutality of these images: Devastated buildings, wreckages, rescue operations, the pain and suffering of those who have relatives under the debris... A little farther away, a memorial with little glass figurines bearing the name of those who died in the disaster, stand over the miniature landscape with small houses in between them. I reminisce the memories of those that lost their lives- now here, now gone- unlived memories that are crystallized in these glasses and that spike the eyes of those that gaze over them... It feels like a simulated experience, indeed, there was a virtual earthquake simulator around here somewhere...Expectedly, the simulator appears as if it has been defunct for a while now... The stage has regular kitchen equipment, cabinets, table and chairs and they are still here, yet the stage that used to shake does not anymore. It now bears the printed sign that says 'out of order' on the green and red painted walls of the simulator. I recall vividly, the 7.4 magnitude tremor being simulated here, as well as the troubling list of things to do in such an event: turn off the gas valves to prevent fire, form a triangle of life beneath the table; drop, cover and hold on for your dear life! Unfortunately, it does not seem possible anymore to learn from experience within this dirty and old space that is uncared for. A mop and a bucket which seems like that are not actively in use are standing next to the wall, which makes me question whether they are used for cleaning the museum or they are part of the scenery on the stage. The unnerving smell and the randomness of broken lights accompany me on my way out. I see an old seismograph, which bears no explanation and one can only guess what it is, another map which shows the earthquake risk in Turkey and a world map next to it. Old, black and white photographs from earlier earthquakes that happened in the city are the last remaining images before I get out. I walk out of the museum, and breathe the open air in the

city whose history is riddled with earthquakes. Is this the museum that such history deserves?>

This piece was written for the Interpreting Data Anthropologically course, which is a part of the master's program. It was written after a revisit to the earthquake culture museum and it reads very much like a commentary on the fleeting time where the author is not only wandering in the museum, but also around his dusty memories, recalling the times when he was a small children in elementary school. The school was opened right after the earthquake to become a home for those children who were affected by the earthquake. This school has been a home to the author since the kindergarten up until the last year of high school, and all of his friends were in one way or another affected by the earthquake. The earthquake simulation in the museum was an integral part of the memories of those children. They not only relived their traumatic memories, but they also in a way learned to cope with those memories; what to do in the event of an earthquake, the basic tips that could make a huge difference in terms of saving lives.

<Lake Sapanca is a fresh water lake that is twenty kilometers away from the center of my hometown, which is the location of earthquake museum in the vignette above. This lake is actually located on a tectonic hole between Gulf of Izmit and the lowlands of Adapazarı, which was the main axis of rupture in the fault that produced the 1999 Earthquake. The tectonic activities are quite literally the causes of the existence of this lake in this place. The Earthquake and its corresponding tectonic activity not only brings this lake into place, it also symbolically brings the three friends in the conversation together. These friends are the part of the friends that I have mentioned in the vignette, that went to the same primary school with me which was a school that was opened to help the victims of the earthquake. After visiting my hometown previous summer, and being in the museum once again; I have come together with them in this lakeside, which is the place of one of our friends' summer house. I use the initial G to refer to my parts in the conversation and use A and B for my friends' parts.

G:...the museum was not in a very good condition, which made me wonder if you guys remember how it was like, or have you been there recently?

A: No, I haven't been there recently

B: I now realize I even forgot about that place's existence before you brought it up

G: Yeah, it's not like how I remember... First of all, the place seemed so small

B: Or maybe we have grown too much

A: Was it the fifth year or the fourth year we were there, I can't recall...

B: I think it was the fourth year, I barely remember the entrance and many photographs around

G: I think the same photographs are still hanging on the walls

A: Yeah, but the main thing was the earthquake simulator... I never forget that

B: You are right! I remember shaking on this platform...

A: The triangle of life...

B: Drop, cover, and hold on...

A: And you could actually change the magnitude of the earthquake in that simulator

B: The quake of our group wasn't so strong

G: That's maybe why you have forgotten about the place

A: I think we have gotten something above 8.0

B: So it was more powerful than '99 earthquake which was 7.4

A: Allegedly...

G: What do you mean?

A: Well, there are rumours I have heard that the magnitude of the earthquake was above 8.0... and that it was deliberately stated as being 7.4

G: Why would they do that?

A: If I remember it correctly, with earthquakes above 7.5 magnitude the government actually needs to declare the whole area as a disaster zone, which requires giving tax exemption to that zone for a couple of years... And we are talking about maybe the most industrialized corridor in our country... It would have collapsed the government and brought down the economy

B: That's a conspiracy if I ever heard one...

G: Yeah, but the thing is, the government did collapse and there was an economic crisis right after the earthquake, the 2001 crisis...

A: Yeah but it could have been much sooner and more drastic... I don't know, it is not something I have researched... only something I heard...>

This informal interview or conversation was written as a part of the same course in the master's program as above. What could be highlighted in this passage is the controversy surrounding the magnitude on the Richter scale which sounds a lot like a conspiracy theory. Aside from evaluating this as a truth claim and then dismissing the absurdity of the statement, there is merit in taking the statement seriously. Deborah Coen notes that Richter's scale has a life of its own, apart from the intentions of its inventor who didn't expect the scale to be universal, and there is a danger of neglecting field observations in the making of the formula: the earthquakes to be defined as magnitude coupled with the epicenter (Coen 2013, 263). Human experiences of earthquakes are reverted to become 'subjective' experiences in the face of rising 'objective' observations that are oscillations which seismographs record and which become visible on the computer screen. Yet, this grave injustice resonates in the rumors of people whose challenge to official accounts of earthquakes are to be taken seriously. There is so much controversy around the officially announced magnitudes of earthquakes because people's experiences cannot be represented with a number on the scale and a location on the map.

<We were sitting together in the guest room of my aunt-in-law's house and there is quite a crowd: my aunt-in-law, her two children who are my cousins, my two aunts, my mother, and another cousin and her daughter. So there were 9 people in the room together with me. I have just 'returned' from Leuven to Adapazarı. I did not expect this interaction to become a part of fieldwork, yet as I was researching 'earthquakes', you can never anticipate when the topic will come up. My aunt-in-law asked me how was my education going and what was I researching. I told her that I was studying 'earthquakes' and she proceeded to tell me about her experience: sometimes at night when she is trying to sleep, she feels this vibration as if an earthquake is happening just as she is falling asleep and she suddenly wakes up. One of my cousins added how this thinking about a coming earthquake is a usual part of her sleep routine. Another cousin adds that he sometimes makes up

scenarios in his head right before he sleeps and in these imaginary scenarios, he makes plans about what to do if an earthquake were to happen at that moment: where would he take cover, what would he do afterwards... I try to show my empathy with them adding that this is what I also often think before I sleep, and it is something that comes up a lot in my conversations with various people.

My aunt-in-law asked me whether I have any 'remedy' to her uneasiness and I answered by saying that I am not an expert in 'psychology' of earthquakes and my 'research' is related with social and cultural aspects of earthquakes. This little conversation triggered questions from one of my cousins who is a research associate in maritime studies in the local university. Our roles were reversed and she started asking me about what anthropology is and what is our research methodology. I was the one who was being interviewed about what anthropology is. In fact, this interaction was not unique to this particular moment because 'anthropology' is quite an 'alien' discipline to a lot of people in Turkey, as it is not very common to study anthropology in Turkey, with so few departments in Turkish universities. There were a lot of cases when I was the one put in the receiving end of the questions about what is it that anthropologists do. So I said I cannot speak as a spokesperson for the entire discipline and you could get as many different answers to these questions as you ask different people working within the boundaries of the discipline. By this moment, everyone in the room was listening to our conversation. I use G to refer to my parts and A to my cousin's.

G: Anthropology is simply put human-science. I study social and cultural anthropology which produces knowledge about humans in societies and their cultures.

A: What kind of approach do you use? I know you can use qualitative or quantitative approaches in science

G: Well, if I had to classify I would say I am more inclined to make use of a qualitative approach that involves participant observation, as in being in the field with the people you are studying.

A: How do you gather your data then? My research uses a lot of quantitative data so I am asking out of curiosity.

G: There are in-depth, semi-formal or informal interviews we make use of. We ask questions to people we are with, trying to get a sense of how they perceive themselves, what they do, and their values, beliefs... But it is certainly not limited to this. You can be involved in activities that people take part in. You record these interactions and you try to make sense of them.

A: It sounds very interesting, but also a bit like it is something more personal.

G: Yeah you could say that, but I think what differentiates anthropology from a lot of other disciplines is its claim for being a holistic science

A: What does that mean, holistic?

G: I would say it means looking at the totality of relations that make up a human being: our research problematizes how knowledge is being produced, it attempts to reveal the power relations inherent in the production of knowledge. Self-reflexivity is a term that is discussed a lot in anthropology.

A: Can you elaborate a bit?

G: So the thing is, it is by now well known that anthropology as a disciplinary framework in the West was initially a colonial endeavour. Powerful people in the West were fascinated by other cultures, they sent their missionaries to these distant lands they were extracting value from. They wanted to know whether they were human like themselves or how different they were from them. As it grew out of this, it started questioning its own beliefs and assumptions about cultural differences. It started showing that this very production of knowledge about other cultures is not so neutral or innocent as they deemed it to be in the first place. So, there is a constant questioning of what anthropologists are actually doing to these other people.

A: But how can you actually incorporate these facts in your research?

G: Well for example, we are now talking about science here and I could make use of this conversation in my research, give an account of our discussion and make sure that I am involving as much about the context we are in as I can. And you know what, this is a particularly good example here because I am not the one asking questions, I am being questioned which is very revealing to me.

A: So you will write about our conversation here too?

G: Well if you are feeling OK with being a part of my research

A: I would be more than happy if I am helping in any way.

G: You are doing more than helping, you are making me question the fundamental assumptions I have about what I am doing.

A: It sounds very different to what I am doing and how I think of science.

G: I don't know, if I had to talk specifically about my approach to anthropology, I don't see it as being something very different than what other people everywhere are doing. See, I am very critical of science being regarded as something only a select few, special people could be doing behind the closed doors and in their ivory towers. My interest in earthquakes is precisely this: When an earthquake happens, that tower collapses and everything is flattened; the hierarchies do not hold. You could say what differentiates me as an anthropologist and perhaps you as a non-anthropologist is that I am a part of an institution that grants a certain legitimacy to my research.

A: Can you really say it is as simple as that?

G: Well, maybe not as simple as that because I have been reading, writing, discussing and really immersing myself in the discipline so that I can say what we are doing is not totally different than what other people are doing. The message here is perhaps that when I will be writing about this conversation here, I will not claim that is something more valuable or more useful than if you were to take our discussions here and make something out of it.

A: You have opened a way of looking at science I haven't really considered before...

By this moment, some of the others in the room already lost their attention in our conversation while others were listening all ears when suddenly my elder aunt interrupted: Look at our children go! They are all grown up and discussing serious things! I am proud of you guys, all of you!>

The context and the conversation which is put forward above was a frequent position during the time in fieldwork. Anthropology is not a discipline that is widely known and popular in Turkey. So, a lot of people that we have come across in the field does not really have any, let alone preconceived idea about what anthropology is, or at least in comparative terms when it is contrasted with disciplines such as sociology or urban studies with whom it shares a lot of research interests in the Turkish context. As Birkalan-Gedik also observes, "Turkey does not share a history of the so-called Western classical anthropological distinction of home and field as

two separate sites located in separate geographies” (Birkalan-Gedik 2018, 6234). But this is not something that was a limitation because people were generally very curious as to understand what this different sounding discipline really does. As we have proposed earlier, much of the confusion that arises from the obscure sounding Greek rooted word ‘antropoloji’ could be cast away and made much more clear if it was to be transformed into ‘insan-bilim’ (human-science).

2x2. Life in Disaster Housing Projects

<MEER is the name given to the disaster housing projects that were planned to be built after the 1999 Marmara Earthquake which means Marmara Earthquake Emergency Recovery Project. My family has moved to these disaster housing projects as soon as our keys were handed to us. I had spent a great deal of my childhood in these projects, and I have a couple of childhood friends that I have come to know solely from this neighborhood. My mother still lives in these disaster housing projects and I had met one of my friends from childhood when I was visiting my mother. After initial catching up in terms of how our lives have evolved, we have got to talking about life in the disaster housing projects. I used A to refer to his parts and used G to refer to my parts. Here’s an excerpt from our dialogue:

A:... Look at this place, they have built this place right after the earthquake claiming that the soil is much safer and rocky compared to the city center whose soil is muddy and prone to earthquake damage. The scientists, they know too much; showing us the safer ways to live our lives. They have brought thousands of people here, built these apartment blocks in which people from all kinds of backgrounds live together.

G: So do you feel like everyone is more or less equal here?

A: They distributed these houses according to lottery, but only the people who owned a house before the earthquake could enter the lottery, so even though there was a sense of connectedness after the earthquake as everyone was in one way or another earthquake victims, it has evolved differently. The renters before the earthquake were not entitled to come here. Although its message were put as giving justice to people, injustice was here even from the beginning.

G: Do you feel like there is social cohesion, do you feel connected to the projects, to your neighbors?

A: Yes, in terms of sharing the space together. But there are frequent clashes in the neighborhood. People did not leave their customs and habits before coming here, they have also brought them. Some of them use the common areas to plant fruits and vegetables, others object saying this isn't a field. Some of them want to build thermal insulation, others say its too costly and there is no need for it. So you get this patchy neighborhood where everyone wants to live according their habits. In this sense, it doesn't feel very cohesive.

G: What about social functions, do people have places they can socialize, come across each other that is apart from their living spaces? I have seen some cafes and parks that were built after I was gone.

A: You see, the plan was to bring all the official functions related to local government here: The governorship, the judiciary and other bureaucracy related buildings. They have done that and then put a cafe over here, a park over there. But the ownership of these social places are distributed according to relationships with the ruling classes in the city. Some people embrace these places like it is their own, others object and do not even go near these places. I hear a lot of people complain about the lack of things to do, they detest that there is not a single shopping mall like the ones in the city center. Everyone needs to go to the city center to buy new clothes, to go to cinema and so on. Especially in the evenings, this place feels like a ghost town. It imposes a certain lifestyle on people.

G: What do you see as the reason behind this?

A: Well I think the plan was initially to direct all the new investments and rebuilding processes towards this newly designed part of the town. But the demolished areas in the city center must have seemed like they were more lucrative to redevelop. They were in proximity to habitual social life that was before the earthquake. The rich people acquired the destroyed areas cheaper than they could. And other rich people have taken a hold of this place, the ones that were close with the new government after the earthquake. Just like the government in the country has been in the same hands since the last 20 something years, our neighborhood representative (muhtar) is the same person since the last 20 years. Once you get a grip of power, you don't tend to let go of it easily. They have even changed the name of this place to July 15

[he's referring to the prevented coup attempt in Turkey on the July 15, 2016]. It reveals how they want to ingratiate the big men that rule the city and the country...>

The Marmara Earthquake Emergency Reconstruction Project or simply the Disaster Housing Projects were employed in the areas affected by the earthquake in 1999. It was funded by the World Bank which worked together with various governmental and non-governmental agencies to bring these housing projects for people affected by the earthquake. There were three stages to these reconstruction plans which made the disaster victims pass through tent cities to prefabricated structures which was planned to be temporary, and then from there to permanent housing projects. Tuncay Bilecen asks whether being an earthquake victim was enough to be considered as a beneficiary in these new housing projects and argues that the answer to such a question reveals the liberal character of the Turkish state; because the beneficiaries in these new projects were determined on the basis of their property ownership before the earthquake. But the World Bank funded reconstruction projects were not the only projects that were built and one interesting project that is noted in Bilecen's account is called the *Arızlı Housing Project*, that was built with the 10 million US Dollars donated by the then Iraqi president Saddam Hussein. These houses were distributed through a points-based system that graded the victims in terms of losing their closed ones and their becoming permanently disabled. Bilecen remarks that these people, even though they were paying their tax, were gradually forced out of these buildings by the law enforcement officers as these houses were redistributed to government officials and bureaucrats (Bilecen 2021).

<...As our conversation was going on with the childhood friend, he says that he was going to meet another of our common friends from the streets of the disaster housing projects. He said it would be nice to get back together after all these years, the three of us, and that I should stick for a bit more to see him, to which I agreed. As he also joined our conversation after some time, we greeted each other and I had to explain what was anthropology to him and what was I doing in Belgium. I use B to refer to his parts in addition to A and G above.

B: ...It was obvious that you were going to become this scientist

G: I am not a scientist, at least not yet

B: Yeah but you were going to the private school with perfect grades, we were teasing you as being a private college baby

A: You were the one doing it, I wasn't a part of it

B: [Laughs] I was sort of a bully back then

A: Yeah, you were bullying me as well

B: Anyway, what are you doing back here in these slums ?

G: My mother still lives here, you know

A: He's doing research on earthquakes

B: Oh right, Camili is the perfect place for researching earthquakes

A: Yeah right?

G: I guess... it's one of the starting points for me, living in these projects

B: You want material for your research? I have recently watched this video on the internet...

G: What's it about?

B: It's the truth about why the 1999 happened here the way it did

A: Why did it happen then?

B: There's a weapon called the HAARP², its an American invention

A: Yeah right, as if 'everything is a game played upon us by the US'

B: It really is, I can send you the video... It says the US has this weapon which can induce artificial earthquakes from far away...

A: It sounds non-sense

G: I don't know, maybe it has some sense, maybe not; but I would approach it with skepticism

B: It's the truth I am telling you...It gives a history of artificial earthquakes in history...

A: It is an outright conspiracy

B: You don't want to see the bigger picture, look at these houses we are living in: they were built by the 'World Bank'

A: And?

B: America controls the 'World Bank', and the murderer always comes back to the scene of the crime....

² High-frequency Active Auroral Research Program

G: So are you saying they have both caused the earthquake and then built the disaster houses?

B: Yeah... To appear as if they are helping us, or saving us so that we can stay indebted to them...>

2x3. Islamic Make-up and 'Cat Bonds'

David S. Sayers (2001) discusses what he calls 'Muslim Theodicy' as it is reflected in the reaction of the Turkish Islamically-motivated media to the Marmara earthquake. Following the newspaper articles for 30 days after the earthquake, he notes the theological position of the Islamic media "by mapping out the Qur'anic matrix for their claims which is contextualized by stating the reactions" (Sayers 2001, 2). Sayers lays down three interpretations of the causes of the earthquake, as the instrument of god, referring to the explanations offered by the newspapers as the following: the majestic interpretation, the merciful interpretation, and earthquake as a trial. These three theological interpretations are weighed upon the Qur'anic matrix by referring their context to the holy book of Qur'an, and then 'tested' by constructing the sociopolitical matrix which are presented as 'outside' factors that "determine how these claims have been weighted and presented" (Sayers 2001, 34). The timely observations of Sayers detects how Turkey's secularization processes have been intricately linked with the position of Islam within the body politic and in the daily life, and shows how the discourse in Islamically-motivated media has seized upon the secular-religious fault line by re-emphasizing the role of Islam in dealing with a catastrophe such as the 1999 Earthquake.

Just as Sayer's piece notes the role of media in shaping the discourse about earthquakes in Turkish public life, it can be combined with the transformation the state following the 1999 Earthquake. Perhaps the relevant projection of this transformation for our discussion can be noted down as the transformation of earthquake risk and insurance regimes, which is exemplified by the introduction of the compulsory earthquake insurance in Turkey after the 1999 earthquake, as well as the creation of Turkish Catastrophe Insurance Pool (TCIP). The role of the state in transforming the land into a commodity, as well as the role of construction sector in

building the hegemony of the state has been noted before (Çavuşoğlu 2021). What is explanatory for our case is the role of the 1999 earthquake in the subsequent 2001 financial crisis in Turkey that has been alleviated by getting loans from the IMF which sought to stabilize the dire effects of the financial crisis. This yields the possibility for a theorization of the earthquake as a 'shock doctrine' by what has been called 'disaster capitalism' (Klein 2007). Klein's theory has received critical engagement by Kai Heron, who revealed how the theory of 'disaster capitalism' assumes there is a 'normal' to return to; whereas he proposes to call the catastrophe cycle as 'capitalist catastrophism':

“Capitalist catastrophism is what happens when capitalist realism begins to fray at the edges. It describes a situation in which capitalism can no longer determine what it means to be “realistic,” not because of the force of movements assembled against it but because capital's self-undermining and ecologically destructive dynamics have outstripped capitalism's powers to control them” (Heron 2020).

Capitalist catastrophism does not put forward a coherent social theory such as disaster capitalism; it reveals the unmaking of social formations in this 'late' phase of capitalism. Foti Benlisoy (2023) uses this concept of capitalist catastrophism and its catastrophe cycles, to argue how 1999 earthquake has been used as an excuse to reinstate the construction-oriented growth strategy as well as becoming the 'ground' of the transformation of the entire legal infrastructure of the urban transformation in the following twenty something years. We could note here how media and financial system operate as complementary forces on the seismopolitical character of the Turkish state, in terms of its seizing upon the disasters to protect the class-based interests. Seismopolitical transformation of the Turkish state reveals the so-called neo-liberal transformation of Turkish economy with its “Islamist” or “Neo-Ottoman” make-up to the corporatist growth strategy that fetishizes construction by attaching self-standing value on 'properties' that is its symbolic hallucination.

<...The following excerpt is a conversation with a friend of mine who works in the risk management department of one of the biggest banks in Turkey. We have been in

communication during the writing of the thesis as I have asked him to explain how certain financial instruments are used in the case of earthquake insurances and risk management. I use A to refer to his parts and G to refer to my parts in the discussion.

G: ...I have been reading upon what is being called catastrophe bonds or simply 'cat bonds' in the financial sector, I wanted to you ask since you are more involved in the financial sector than I am

A: Yeah, I am not directly working with catastrophe bonds but I know some things about them

G: Would you care to elaborate for me what they entail?

A: A catastrophe bond is simply a bond or an insurance linked security, which is a sort of debt arrangement... It allows for the issuer to get a sum of money from the holder of these bonds for a fixed term in return for a promise of interest payment. In the case of catastrophe bonds, they are used for hedging the risks disasters such as earthquakes to the financial markets

G:What does this hedging mean?

A: It is simply a strategy to limit the risk of a financial asset

G: The asset being earthquakes in this sense?

A: Yeah, it is a derivate of earthquake insurances... the financial effects of earthquakes are huge which can be observed in the 1999 Earthquake and its subsequent financial crisis of 2001... Turkey has changed the legislation to make earthquake insurance compulsory and created the Turkish Catastrophe Insurance Pool which collects the earthquake insurance payments in a sort of pool and then hedges the risk of earthquakes to the financial markets... For example, TCIP works with a reinsurance firm where they create a market for selling cat bonds which promises to pay something like two percent or three percent per year as the investors can choose to have their money stay within the pool for a fixed period of time. TCIP takes all the money and puts it in a bank account which is backed by US dollars...

G: This is the case if an earthquake does not happen, right?

A: Yes, if an earthquake doesn't happen, then the interest payments get done smoothly... But if an earthquake happens that triggers the parameters which is

determined before, then TCIP takes all the money to pay for the earthquake insurance payers in Turkey for their claims

G: How do these parameters get determined?

A: Well I cannot pinpoint the formula right now but it involves a precise mathematical modelling that takes a lot of factors into account such as the magnitude, intensity and so on...

G: It sounds like the wealthiest people are gambling with the prospects of human life on a mass scale

A: Well, it really depends on how you want to look at it.. In another sense, this is how the economy works and the state is trying to minimize the financial risk of disasters such as earthquakes

G: Couldn't the state just make the houses safer and earthquake resistant instead of gambling with the lives of the countless humans?

A: It would not make much financial sense if the state cannot find the necessary resources for taking such a massive reconstruction project...>

3.ANTHROPOLOGY FROM THE BORDERS OF THE OUTSIDE

3x0. Dialogue with the Neighbors of the Inside

<Greek cultural anthropologist Nadia Seremetakis brings together various fragments from her multi-sited and self-reflexive ethnographic explorations in Sensing the Everyday: Dialogues from Austerity Greece (2019). For Seremetakis, anthropology is best understood as to mean dialogue, which is best reflected in her “antinomic subject position” throughout the book that leads to her recognition of the positionality of “a native or indigenous ethnographer” who is at the same time a “diasporic, American-trained, post-Boasian anthropologist”, as it exemplifies the placed emphasis on the dialogic relationship between her various ethnographic projects and the discipline in its broader sense (Seremetakis 2019, 5). The various montages that are juxtaposed in this book are based on fieldwork experiences and observations of the quotidian within the era of crisis, as a mixture of theoretical analyses with ethnographic data collected over years. The focus on the everyday life within the context of socio-economic crisis of Greece is employed through a lens

that takes into account the fracturing effects of this crisis with its corresponding saturation of the everyday life with insecurities.

Immersion within this interstitial analysis is evinced out of the “gaps, silences and dead spaces” that operate in this non-signifying space. This encapsulation of the quotidian within the macro logical is ultimately a structural effect and political technology of the superstructure according to Seremetakis, who is ultimately interested in the ethnography of the quotidian as it is rendered as lacking security. One of the employed methods can effectively be called “the excavation of historical experience of fracture” which attempts at a politicization of the micro logical by exposing the social fictioning of the social reality, transforming the power (puissance) of the everyday experiences into a reservoir of alternative perceptions of reality as the aim of the ethnographic project (Seremetakis 2019, 3). It is a political task under the conditions of globalization and neocolonial practices that seek to produce the homogenous and totalizing authority of the sameness, framed as a pseudo-culture devoid of meaning. The focus on the everyday does not effectuate a sacralization of every day life nor its recession into a foreclosed zone outside the reach of the political violence. The quotidian is made concrete as the material forces of fragmentary and fragmenting kind, which are performatively enacted in the style of the book as it is best conceived as an assemblage of fragments, and not as a story shaped ethnography told in a linear fashion.

Perhaps this book review could be devised as a kaleidoscopic exploration of these constellations which produce ethnographic affects as well as the initiation of a dialogical relationship that converges both methodically and thematically with my ethnographic project. The highlighted quotidian processes that are on the spaces of border, spaces of trauma, and the journey of antiphonic witnessing and memory have concrete resonances with the project I am trying to pursue. Out of the many ethnographic miniatures that are juxtaposed within the context of this book, the amplified resonances that guide my exploration thematically involve the spatialization of memory, the archaeology of non-standard forms of language, the sensory experiences of physical and social disasters which Seremetakis talks about in the context of “eruption of death in the city” that accompany the “eruption of the earth

and the death of the city itself” (Seremetakis 2019, 6). The ethnographic explorations of Seremetakis in Kalamata after an earthquake has devastated the city, provides an excellent guiding thread for my ethnographic project focusing on the earthquake that has devastated my hometown in 1999 in Turkey. This perfect point for establishing a dialogical relationship between experiences of trauma within the face of disasters actually reflects the efforts of the earthquake diplomacy that was established between Greece and Turkey after the earthquakes of 1999 in respective countries.

Dialogue with Seremetakis allows me to move past the dominant public culture and mnemotechnics of remembering and forgetting it dictates, and focus on the quotidian processes and the lived experiences of the everyday in dealing with what she calls third stream memory or anamnesis. These alternative forms of public reminiscence that are excavated from the ruined space of a post-disaster city are simultaneously an archaeology of non-standard forms of language that come to life between the porous borders of life and death as well as bodies and concepts. Seremetakis is interested in the alternative memories of collective experience which are other than the ones that are archived by various institutions and media. She suggests that memory is in fact “sensory and embedded in matter”, as it can be found in the affective relationship between places and biographies, stored and miniaturized within objects that resurface sedimented emotions and narratives, it is linked to various senses: “The urban space dismembered by disaster becomes a body without organs” (Seremetakis 2019, 56).

Seremetakis’ reflections on disaster victims and the diagnostics she puts forward in terms of post-disaster flexible citizenship with its principles in neoliberal models of citizenship, enables her to reveal how these people have become “internal refugees” in their own national spaces, being rendered “infra-political”, liminal and homeless. But this reflection of victims is not mediatic witnessing which is appropriative according to Seremetakis. She contrasts this mediatic witnessing with antiphonic witnessing and remarks that the media is not interested in creating public memory, whereas antiphonic witnessing establishing dialogue is an engagement with an other, a “creation of a separate place” as a prerequisite for witnessing others and being witnessed by them. (Seremetakis 2019, 74) The dialogue initiated with

Seremetakis in this review can create this separate place as it is fruitful in terms of a shared sensibility within the context of socio-economic crises of the everyday.

Overall, the book is a very dense and condensed assemblage of ethnographic explorations of an anthropologist whose career spans over long years of engagement with the field and the discipline. I have chosen to focus on the most relevant aspects of these fragments for my ethnographic project and have unfortunately left behind massive parts not included in this review. I have chosen to focus on the employed methodologies in terms of the ethnographic explorations and have tried to convey the most resonant themes that are explored with these methodologies in mind. The book has not only initiated dialogue and antiphonic witnessing with Seremetakis but also facilitated the dialogue with my 'self' and its internalized other. It has helped the creation of a separate place for reflection on my own everyday experiences and the experiences in the fieldwork...>

This book review was written as a part of the Interpreting Data Anthropologically course. Seremetakis is an important influence, not just as a part of the master's program in Leuven, but also in the bachelor's program in Istanbul. Our first interaction with Seremetakis was in the Social Memory course that was in the Sociology program in Bogazici University, in which we have read a part from the *The Senses Still* (1994). Just as a watery fruit takes her to a journey in her memories in that book, reading and listening to her has made us think a lot about how to deal the problem of memory. In the beginning of this semester, Seremetakis gave the inaugural lecture for the Anthropology program in Leuven. There was a sense of confusion as to the title of her inaugural lecture which was "*Anthropology from the Borders of the Inside*". As an homage to this title, we have decided to name this phase of the present study "*Anthropology from the Borders of the Outside*". The reasons for giving such a title to the present phase of our study is a sort of "disagreement" on the margins of the everyday, a fruitful one in that, to produce an effect that will become clearer as we continue. The border of Turkey and Greece is a reflection of such a disagreement, one that is immensely close yet also so far away.

<If the European Union can be thought as a castle, it feels like Greece stands on the borders of the inside whereas Turkey stands on the borders of outside. Greece seems so beautiful from the Aegean shores of Anatolia, yet our entry as Turkish citizens is very problematic. Before I have come to study in Leuven, I had never been to Greece in my life. There is a very intimate relationship and history these two countries share with one another, yet to be denied easy entry to a land that is so close but so far away has always raveled my mind. I had a personal aspiration to go to Greece ever since 1999 Marmara Earthquake. Right after the earthquake, Greeks were the first to send us help. I remember receiving boxes of aid; clothes, toys, pencils, notebooks that were coming from Greece. Put yourself in my situation, a small child that has lost everything to wreckage: every toy, every clothing, every piece that was so personal to me got trapped under the rubble. In a sense, with each new item that was in the box of aid we opened, there was a new potentiality to reconstruct our livelihoods. There was also quite a powerful earthquake that hit Athens 20 days after the Marmara Earthquake. And Turkey was the first to sent help to Greece as well. Two countries have an official history of Earthquake diplomacy.

In a 'true' anthropological fascination with the cultural other, so to speak, I initially wanted to make the present study about this Earthquake diplomacy by researching the not-so-official aspects of the the earthquake intimacy the people from these countries share. However, I have found it very difficult to find resources to pursue an engaged fieldwork in Greece, as well as a linguistic limitation in terms of my lack of knowledge in Greek language. Yet, this did not stop me from visiting Greece given that I now had the Schengen visa to be freely moving inside the European Union. I seized upon this fact and paid a visit to the city of Pythagoreio in the island of Samos. So many asylum seekers try to make that boat trip from Turkey to Greece, and in a lot of these cases, their boats are pushed back to where they are coming from. Others do not end up so lucky, sometimes their dead bodies are washed up onto a shore. But that little magical residence permit and a few hundred euros can secure your visit to the islands of Greek; you are more than welcome to visit these islands by boat if you have the permit and the money to reach these islands. Perhaps, this little fact was enough to make me sick, or perhaps it was due to

something entirely different, but I have spent most of my time in Pythagoreio vomiting and shivering with a fever.

In other times where I wasn't feeling so sick, I have enjoyed the beautiful sea and the delicious food as a tourist. I was surprised when we got approached by a waiter who was working in a restaurant that recognized our speech and started talking with us in Turkish. But then I realized that this shouldn't be so surprising to anyone who has been there, because you can literally see the mainland of Turkey from this island and it is much closer to it than it is to the Greek mainland. There are thousands of tourists coming from Turkey to this island. I didn't assume any 'anthropologist' identity in this conversation and I have found this to be a relief. I casually asked the "interlocutor" whether he was here on the island when the 2020 Aegean Sea earthquake happened. He said it was a powerful one but the Aegean Sea is like a cradle that is endlessly swinging, and that you can tell by the actions of the tourists, in terms of how they react to the shaking, whether they have ever experienced an earthquake before or not. I thanked him for sharing this "ethnographic observation" with me. He was more of an anthropologist in this sense than I could ever be on this island.>

And perhaps, this is our disagreement with Seremetakis. Looking back at the notes taken during the inaugural lecture, she differentiates the anthropologist from a tourist and one can see the reasons behind this differentiation. But there is a sense in which a transposition like the one told above can happen in the context of a touristic activity, and this is not something that should be neglected even if you are ideologically against tourism. The waiter that shares his ethnographic observation is producing anthropological knowledge, whether he assumes the identity of anthropologist or not. He is making observations as to how people react to earthquakes and figuring out who has been in an earthquake before or not, based on the observations he has made. He has seen enough earthquakes on this island and enough people visiting this island to be saying something like that. Are we at fault here for including this interaction in our study? This is debatable. But ethnographic observation and "dialogue" is not a property of anthropologists, and for the purpose of such demonstration, the interaction above finds its place in the

present study. We are not claiming the ownership of this ethnographic observation nor the anthropological knowledge here. We might be ‘condemned’ to be perceived as tourists when we are traveling from anywhere to everywhere, and we find no use in pushing for this differentiation between tourists and anthropologists for any reason whatsoever. It still sounds like the last bit of hope and value that the anthropologist attaches to one’s endeavor in order to be able to say that one’s different from the others.

3x1. Swinging from a Hilltop in Athens

<In another ‘touristic’ exploration in Greece, we were wandering around the limestone hills of Strefi in the neighborhood of Exarcheia and it was where we have met ‘Don Juan’. For all intents and purposes, I will keep calling this man Don Juan out of personal reasons and to occlude his identity as well as forming a likeness with the infamous Don Juan in Carlos Castaneda’s books. Our Don Juan was somewhat different than Castaneda’s but in a lot of other senses, I could not help myself but think about those books that tell the story of Don Juan during this interaction (Castaneda 2016; Castaneda 2018). When we first saw him on top of a rock on this hill, he seemed to have found his ‘place’ and perhaps he was already expecting us to find him. He was sitting there in the face of the sun, so sure of his place under the bright sky and above the city of Athens overlooking the Acropolis. He was an Alevi-Kurdish sage, an expert in medicinal herbs, as well as a miner, and he had many patients and animals that he was caring for. Out of many stories he has told in many places he has been, I will focus on and re-express his story of coming to Greece.

Living in the Bağcılar neighborhood of Istanbul in the 1990’s, which is a workers’ district, he was hand printing a weekly journal which involved a lot of satire and controversy about the daily affairs. In one of the issues of this weekly journal, he had written a poem claiming ‘There is no God’ and ‘Religion is a Lie’, which apparently got him into a lot of trouble. He was sued with nonsense charges, nonsense because such a statement is ‘normally’ protected under the freedom of expression principle in the secular judiciary system of Turkey. At this moment, he goes back to his childhood and recalls a time he was working in the mines somewhere in central Anatolia. He

had spent considerable time in jail because they were protesting the sale of these mines to foreign companies, and he recalls the times he was tortured in jail. 'I could not go back to jail' and the tipping point happened in 1999, with the Marmara Earthquake. Right after the earthquake, he went to work in the rescue operations since he knew how to work within debris, within the wreck as he is a miner. He says he had not even needed too many equipments, as miners know how to work with minimal equipment and perfectly with their hands. He had pulled out countless, dead and alive bodies out of the ruins. After these rescue operations, he came to a realization: The situation in the country was a mess, and his trial was not going anywhere as he sensed that he was going into jail once more. So, he had taken the last resort and escaped the country on a boat. He hasn't been back to Turkey ever since.

"...Look at this soil, look at these trees: why do you think I am here in Greece? It is the closest I can be on Earth to my own soil, as a human being is rooted in one's soil. One knows how to work one's soil, with one's bare hands. One knows how to grow and take care of these trees, because one is one with the soil, with the trees. Anyone who is forcing you to 'say grace' (şükür etmek) is exploiting you using religion and God. Do not ever believe them! Find your places under this sky, and don't let anyone trick you into believing non-sense..." After a couple of hours on this hilltop, which felt like an eternity in one's lifetime, we were taught the secrets of inclined walking on these hills, and went down to the city with him. He talked about how these neighborhoods have changed ever since the 'crisis', as it was never the same as before. He had stood us to a treat and bought us food, which we enjoyed together. It was getting late and we walked towards the city center saying thank you for the shared time and the food. He said that we can probably find him on these streets if you ever end up again in Exarcheia. Right before we left, he had shown us the mural of 'Berkin Elvan', the 15 year old boy who was killed by the police during the Gezi Park protests. We waved back at him, at Berkin and all those who have lost their lives or exiled because of political violence in Turkey...>

Following up from the last chapter where we have tried to demonstrate that the assumed difference between an anthropologist and a tourist could be cast at

another attempt at securitization of the place of the anthropologist, the excerpt above takes the discussion to one step further and forms a parallel with Castaneda's Don Juan. Of course this likeness does not exist out there in the personhood of our "interlocutor", nor in the account of Don Juan given in Castaneda's books; it solely exists within the text, functioning as a limit to our account. Instead of Don Juan, the "interlocutor" could have been called 'Mansur' after the 9th century Sufi mystic Al-Hallaj, whose utterance "I am the Real(truth)" has been a controversy in Islamic thought for centuries and who is reportedly preached building the model of Kaaba at one's dwelling for personal worshipping.³ Perhaps if the statement could be secularized or profanized, we could see our Mansur to have been advising us to build ourselves an observatory at home rather than finding solace in the transcendences of modern science and its claim for any authority over us. In Sufism, or simply *tasavvuf*, *fana* or *fena*, is the annihilation of 'self' or the human 'ego', the ultimate station a mystic can pass in one's total dissolution of the subjectivity in one.

<Just as we were leaving Athens to go to Istanbul, there was a question tingling in our ears: it wasn't what we have 'gained' from this voyage in Athens but what has been left behind. Any voyage would change its saturation with meaning if one were to not ask 'what have I gained from this trip' but ask 'what is it that we are leaving behind', and who is this 'us' that is moving on in the departure from what has been left behind. Perhaps this is the gist of the difference between an anthropologist and a tourist that Seremetakis was pointing at: the anthropologist should never ask what have I gained from this interaction as a consumer of landscapes and services that appears as if they are there for the extraction of value by selling it to the tourists. The anthropologist always leaves behind, annihilates its own subjectivity, its own researcher identity where the difference becomes imperceptible. And when it becomes impossible to be differentiated from the tourists is our reporting in 'disagreement' with Seremetakis. Who's to say what differentiates an anthropologist that appropriates the meaning for oneself from a tourist; or conversely what differentiates an anthropologist rid of this sufficiency from a tourist that does not appropriate but leaves behinds, does not extract value but dissolves meaning in

³ <https://iranicaonline.org/articles/hallaj-1>

things left behind, materials and memories which are one and the same thing in the last instance...

But more specifically, we could ask what has been really left behind in Athens? One possible answer is an old jacket that had some 'euros' and that magical little 'residence permit' the European Union gives us and asks us one more time to identify who we are. The realization that you have lost your 'identity' is a traumatic one; after bureaucratic phone calls with the Belgian consulate in Athens and in Istanbul, the best way forward has been decided as moving to Istanbul to apply for a visa to be able to go back to Belgium after the loss of the residence permit. You lose your identity and you are not 'secure' anymore to go back to where you are legally residing... Going through the visa application process for the second time is still as dehumanizing as it was for the first time... While it could 'secure' your place in Belgium a second time, it also 'secures' your position as an outsider, a temporary one in that, for a second time in the same gesture...>

3x2. Pangaea of our Common Dreams/Nightmares

<...In the beginning of February this year, we woke up to a terrible morning with the news of very strong earthquake devastating the southern parts of Turkey and the northern parts of Syria. After some phone calls and messages to the friends that are from those regions, I felt ruined staying in my room without being able to do anything other than read the news online. So I went outside and walked to 'Pangaea' in the social sciences campus in Leuven. The earthquake was all that we could talk about with the few friends gathered there, sharing with each other the 'news' we were able to gather from various sources. And then we were hit by the news of a second powerful earthquake hitting the same region which had blackened the already dark mood that was among us. Everything lost its meaning, as our presence far away from those that try to find their families under debris, had caused the loss of our direction in life. The dark screen of our phones or computers were acting like pointed needles, bleeding our eyes with each passing 'news' from the region.

It was the very same days when I was struggling to devise this present study, with questions such as 'Have I gathered enough data?' or 'Have I done enough?', when all of a sudden everything I touch, every piece of information, every little interaction with the people that were far away and close by, had the prospect of becoming 'data' in my work. Day after day, I was struggling with being weak and powerless to help anyone affected by the earthquake, as well as trying to cope with being overwhelmed with the sense of direction I had in my life, in terms of what I was doing in Leuven, what I was doing researching 'earthquakes', what I was doing studying anthropology and so on; my thoughts and mood were in free-fall towards a bottomless pit that felt paradoxically like being under the rubble of a wrecked house. It was not just this free-fall within ruins that felt overwhelming, it was also the feeling of being outright wrong or unjustified in feeling the things I was experiencing as if my situation could be compared with the people that were looking for their loved ones, dead or alive, within the ruins or in mass graves that were opened. I was not only feeling wrong for going through such a disaster as a collectivity, I was by the same move feeling wrong 'including' myself in that collectivity as if my suffering was anything substantial.

I had tried to send any money I spared for my 'leisure' to any call for help I received from friends or organizations working in the field to help the victims. The more I was sending the more it felt wrong as if 'money' was the only instrument I could channel my grief and desire to help people. It was then when we were approached by the office members of Pangaea who asked us whether they could help us in any way, and they have been very helpful in suggesting that we could organize a gathering here in Pangaea for solidarity purposes. Initially, I did not feel like I had any energy or motivation for such an event; but with every person I have shared the prospect of having a solidarity event, I was sensing the sparks of what would turn out to be a pretty big event, at least in my own standards. Slowly and confusingly, we have formed an online group for discussing the possibility of such an event and what we could be doing.

The plan was decided as to bring 'food', more specifically 'local' food from Turkish and Syrian cuisine that was sold to raise money to send to the organizations working

on the field in the earthquake affected regions. As the organizing committee, we decided to make the 'bake sale' a non-commercial activity by not including any commercial venture to use the platform for their advertisement purposes. There were a lot of people, students and non-students, as well as other businesses, restaurants and others, from all over Leuven and Belgium that supported our cause by bringing what they can for sale. In a few hours, almost all the food was finished. There was quite a queue in and out of Pangaea, where the solidarity event has taken place. Some people said they couldn't wait in the queue but still wanted to help, so they have put money in the donation box we have prepared. There were a lot of cases where people gave more money than the value of food they 'bought'.

A few days later, KU Leuven sent the 'Turkish and Syrian community' an e-mail to invite to an informal meeting. This event was planned to bring together people from these communities to connect and share the questions, concerns and reflections with the university's administrative staff. I did not know what to expect from this meeting before going there and when I arrived, I was surprised to see the whole top level administrative staff of the university there. Taking place in the Jubileumzaal, I was mesmerised by this splendid hall which I hadn't been in before. Arranged as a reception, there were snacks (should I call it Canapé?) on the tables, as well as wine and other drinks which was also striking to me as I had no idea what to expect from this meeting. Another thing that made me think a lot about was the reverberation effect this hall added to the human voice: Anyone speaking had the backing of reflections that strike from all over the place.

The issue I want to bring into our discussion here was perhaps the only contentious moments in this whole encounter: the issue of aid and which organization to trust with your money to help those on the ground. This topic was also one of the critical discussions in our solidarity event in Pangaea. As we had known beforehand, KU Leuven had donated to Belgian Red Cross and as far as the international agreements are concerned, Belgian Red Cross was working in cooperation with Turkish and Syrian Red Crescent. But if anything our experiences with 'war' in these countries show us, it is that every single issue, including humanitarian aid in the event of such a catastrophe, is politicized through and through. There were 'scandals' of Turkish

Red Crescent, such as selling tents to the organizations working on the ground, or the Syrian Red Crescent being evidently non-existent in the northern parts of Syria. These points about the politicized nature of humanitarian aid were raised as something to be discussed by two of the attendees, from Turkey and Syria respectively, which had aroused discussions within the hall. Another attendee has added that he has worked with the Syrian Red Crescent before and that they were a legitimate organization trying to help the victims. There was also an attendee that had come to make a critical observation to the attendee that raised the topic of politicization of humanitarian aid. That critical observation had to do with 'discrediting' the Turkish Red Crescent in the face of an international crowd, as he had claimed that "someday in the future the government might change but that 'discrediting' comments might stick in the minds of such an international crowd".

A couple of weeks later, we organized another solidarity event in Pangaea that had the same concept of bake sale as well as an open microphone that involved live musical performances on voluntary basis. The money collected in both of these events in Pangaea was sent equally to organizations in Turkey and Syria. These events helped me to get to know a lot of people that I hadn't met before, and share moments in solidarity with each other. There are a lot of people that took responsibility in making these events come to life and the least I can do with my writing here is to thank everyone that has played a role in it...>

3x3. Epilogue/Postscript on the Emergent Human-Science

The present study is devised as a 4x4 matrix, where each chapter can be put into an operation with any other chapter to make up various phases. The way it is presented here is just one of the ways it could have been presented, as any other way of presentation would be possible in other circumstances.

In the first phase, we have introduced the central concepts of the study as the theory of cultural tectonics and the complementary seismopolitics. If the theory of cultural tectonics is an attempt at horizontal placing of the concepts we have dealt with in the first phase, the arising seismopolitics is the vertical seizure of these

concepts that indexes them as immanent to the present study. Earthquakes have affected humans as far back as we can think of anything that remotely resembles humans, and our miniature conceptual history of earthquakes is just one set of these affections that we have detected out of countless interactions that could have been actualized and written down. Such a dealing is enabled by the presence of a non-dwelling perspective which is the 'secret' echo whispers in one's ears.

In the second phase of the study, we have attempted to mark down the movement of our concepts, which is evident by the structure 'from...to...' that functioned as a 'test' of our concepts in presenting such undertaking within the context of the discipline that is anthropology. We have moved from the canonical formula of Levi-Strauss to reveal the inverted ethnographic function of 'fractality'; from the ethnographic present to the third-person's perspective in Marx and Laruelle; from a relation of self-resonance or tautological value exchange towards a conception of fractal identity; and from an anthropological or philosophical conception of 'measurement' that comes from observation towards quantum decoherence.

The third phase of our study has shifted its terrain from dealing with 'imported' concepts towards the problematic that cannot be accurately presented due to an impossibility of accurate translation. This is our 'going native' phase where we have considered this impossibility not as something restrictive but as an enabling impossibility that is evident from our axiom. We have also presented the method for the corresponding phase through an account of the theory of 'coordinates of life'. After such deliberation, we have presented a 'biography of an ordinary anthropologist' who attempts to write down the present study; who conceives the 'life in disaster housing projects' as one of the starting points for such an attempt; as well as dealing with the saturation of daily life in these projects with an 'Islamic make-up and catastrophe bonds' that are the re-enchantments of a disenchanted modern life in disaster housing projects.

In the fourth phase of our study, we have embarked on a dialogue with our neighbors that we share a kind of earthquake intimacy with, swinging from hills of Athens towards the university halls of Leuven, finding solidarity in the Pangaea of

our common dreams or nightmares. And here we are in the epilogue of the final phase which can also be read as a postscript on the emergent human-science that we have proposed in the beginning of the third phase where we have considered 'going native'. The accounts, conversations or coordinates we have given above is the fictionalized reporting of 'lived experiences' or echoes that are heard-in-rhythm by suspending the frequency in earthquakes and human speech as the standing wave of rhythmic superposition.

The present study can be considered as a (counter-)gift to the tautological value system that we observe to have made anthropology drown in its self-image, or to have made it a buzzword that self-resonates in only hearing and speaking (of) itself. If we have employed any critical attitude, it is directed towards such a sufficiency of the anthropological discipline. And if there were any analyses here, it was certainly not an analysis of the ethnographic data that was presented in the later part of the study. This is a deliberate choice, although it could be regarded as a limitation by some. We acknowledge that all of this might sound counter-intuitive to those people who regard it as a limitation. But this is precisely the point.

The 'data' presented should be regarded as a prolegomena to an upcoming 'insan-bilim' (human-science) of the future rather than any anthropology of the past. The reader is not only free to interpret the data as they want, they are encouraged to interpret the data presented in the later part of the study on their own, in hopes that they also might partake in our bringing of this human-science into life. Such is our undertaking of the process that might sound like a terrible joke to some ears, yet as the punchline in this whole proceeding goes: *It is not my fault...*

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